

After Action Review

of UNDP's response to hurricanes Irma and Maria

September-December 2017



*Empowered lives.
Resilient nations.*



UNDP Crisis Response Unit

Acknowledgements

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Altogether 72 people from throughout the response generously gave their time for interviews, and 39 people answered the online survey.

Several staff from throughout HQs and the field provided substantial feedback on drafts. While this feedback was appreciated and definitely improved the overall report, it did not always agree with the findings of the document review, interviews and survey. In the end this report aims to contain a fair and balanced reflection of what was observed, even though this might not fully satisfy all stakeholders.

Finally, James Murray provided very capable support for the editing of the final report.

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List of Acronyms

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Executive Summary

The overall consensus of UNDP's response to hurricanes Irma and Maria is that the deployments were quick and of high quality, external coordination was enhanced by the Crisis Management Unit but could have been better on the needs assessments, and the programming achieved its results but only after operational and procurement delays.

What went well?

Clear and confident decision-making by RBLAC definitely helped bring together a strong response both in terms of deployments and whole-of-agency support for the financing and implementation of a complex programme. The decision to establish a Crisis Management Unit in Dominica strengthened field coordination and paved the way for longer-term engagement by UNDP. Key strategic relationships were developed with China, CDB and CARICOM; and UNDP gained credibility through the Donor Conference. Finally, the Business Case proved itself to be a valuable instrument for planning UNDP's own transition from response (CRU) to recovery (RBLAC).

What could have been improved?

Across the board - in the newly-created field offices in Antigua and Dominica, in the Multi-Country Office in Barbados and in the Regional Hub in Panama - there was a shortage of critical programme, operations and administrative staff at key moments. This inhibited both analytical and coordination work, and most importantly programme delivery. While the PDNAs and the BDA were generally well-regarded, the PDNAs suffered from lack of coordination with ECLAC, and the BDA missed opportunities to join up with the humanitarian community in ways that would have enhanced the system-wide response. The SURGE planning process was not well linked with RBLAC, such that there were differing views on short vs longer term priorities resulting in a SURGE plan that identified the appropriate long-term priorities but that was not used to frame the immediate programming response. At all levels of analysis, planning and programming, Gender Equality and the Empowerment of Women and Girls was very weak.

High-level recommendations for a similar sudden onset crisis in the Caribbean?

RBLAC should concentrate its capacity and instruments for Caribbean crisis response in Barbados, thereby gaining some economies of scale and connecting with the epicentres of donor and system coordination. RBLAC should further invest in emergency preparedness in the region, including specific scenario-based contingency planning and training (under way), and prepositioning. All MCOs in the region should have the minimum amount of resources available to establish and maintain relationships with key government departments in the small island states, so that these relationships can be quickly activated in the event of a crisis.

1. Introduction

1.1 Country situation and context

In September 2017 two hurricanes in quick succession hit the Caribbean; the islands of Barbuda, Dominica, British Virgin Islands (BVI), St Maarten and Turks and Caicos requested international assistance. Despite relatively few casualties, the hurricanes caused massive damage to the economic and social infrastructure and severely impacted the livelihoods of disaster-affected communities.

UNDP deployed first responders to five affected locations and crisis coordination mechanisms were activated. A SURGE planning team was sent out, and a second wave of 3-month Early Recovery Advisors were deployed. About one month after the events, two Post Disaster Needs Assessments (PDNA) were triggered in Antigua and Barbuda, and Dominica, and preparations started for a Donor Conference. With a view to determining its role to sustain recovery efforts, UNDP initiated a planning process known as the Business Case. By December, many elements were in place for the Crisis Response Unit (CRU) to hand over the future steps to the Regional Bureau for Latin America and the Caribbean (RBLAC).

1.2 Objectives of After Action Review

The objective of this AAR is to examine the relevance, the efficiency, the effectiveness of UNDP response to the crisis in Sint Maarten, Barbados, Dominica, British Virgin Islands and Antigua and Barbuda during the period from September 2017 to December 2017.

The AAR will highlight lessons learned that would help strengthen the functioning, performance and efficiency of UNDP response including: UNDPs corporate and country level programmatic and operational response; UN and interagency coordination; contribution to PDNAs and recovery processes.

2. Methodology

Starting prior to the fieldwork stage, and continuing throughout the evaluation, the methodology consisted in a review of approximately 80 publicly available and UNDP-supplied internal documents regarding the Irma and Maria responses, including mandating documents, briefing notes, mission reports, assessments and strategies (see annexes). This formed the basis for a preliminary analysis included later in this document. A notable addition to the documentation was an in-workshop self-assessment carried out by CRU at a workshop in Barbados in June 2018.

2.1 Scope of After Action Review

As an after-action review, the analysis is limited to an assessment of the decisions, actions and short-term outputs of response as recorded in the documentation and interviews with staff. It is not intended as an evaluation of the overall impact of UNDP's response to hurricanes Irma and Maria, which would require a

longer and empirically-grounded methodological approach. A simple analytical framework has been utilised, with a focus on presenting ‘what worked well’ and ‘what could have worked better’. To verify the validity and accuracy of analytical findings, conclusions and recommendations, a preliminary report will be shared with AAR participants and key stakeholders.

2.2 Overview of information needed

Based on the Terms of Reference, the methodological focus of the AAR was to review the design and implementation of UNDP’s response to the Irma and Maria crisis with a focus on identifying those factors (internal UNDP and external contextual factors) that contributed to or limited its overall effectiveness and efficiency. The AAR will address the following primary questions:

1. How effective was UNDP’s internal coordination?
2. How timely and efficient was UNDP’s management and decision-making during the immediate response phase?
3. How did UNDP balance immediate recovery activities with longer term programmatic engagement?
4. What is the best way to organize and provide support in a UNDP multi-country office setting?
5. How to support a crisis affected country / territory where UNDP has no presence?
6. How efficient was the UNDP SURGE mechanism and the Business Case approach? How did the two mechanisms complemented each other’s / overlapped?
7. How relevant, efficient and effective were the main contributions of UNDP to the crisis response (includes programme and operations elements) particularly with the immediate versus medium/longer term actions?
8. How effective was UNDP’s communications and resource mobilization?
9. Would it be any suggestions for changes in the UNDP crisis response policies and tools?
10. What are the lessons learned from the OCHA-UNDP Crisis Management Unit in Dominica?

2.3 Data collection and analysis

Information and data for the AAR was collected from a comprehensive desk review of UNDP documentation, as well as an online survey, key informant interviews and a regional disaster preparedness workshop.

Desk review of UNDP documentation: starting prior to the fieldwork stage, and continuing throughout the evaluation, this consisted of a review of approximately 80 publicly available and UNDP-supplied internal documents regarding the Irma and Maria responses, including mandating documents, briefing notes, mission reports, assessments and strategies. (see Annex 2 for Desk Review Bibliography)

Online survey: a targeted and unilingual online survey was administered to 40 key stakeholders and to the 24 deployees. This was pushed out by e-mail based upon e-mail addresses provided by UNDP. The survey contained a fixed set of core questions, and then had separate skip-logic pathways and differentiated questions for different groups of stakeholders. The survey received 33 full responses, slightly over 50%. The narrative survey comments are attached as Annex 5.

Key informant interviews: key informants included all primary stakeholders, and selected secondary stakeholders in the region (see Annex 1). Several people were interviewed for each of the five affected

countries or territories, including first responders and Early Recovery Advisors in each location. Altogether 72 people were interviewed. In addition there was a focus group discussion with five displaced persons in an IDP shelter in Antigua.

Regional disaster preparedness workshop: in order to capture the views of a wide range of stakeholders, and in particular to hear the views of host country representatives who were not from the planned field visit countries, the consultant observed a previously-planned Caribbean Lessons Learned and Disaster Preparedness workshop being held in Barbados on 12-15 June.

2.4 Validation of findings

In order to ensure the validity of findings, the consultant organised a virtual debriefing after the field visits involving CRU and the field coordinator. Subsequently, after the report was available in final draft form, the consultant provided an in-person restitution session in New York, with a view to ensuring that the recommendations are relevant and implementable.

3. Analysis of the UNDP Response

3.1 Contextual factors influencing the response

A number of factors relating to the country context, operational and institutional environments influenced the design and implementation of the UNDP crisis response for Yemen. These include:

- **Two hurricanes in quick succession**, which caused massive damage to infrastructure and housing in five small island states: Barbuda, Dominica, BVI, St Maarten and Turks and Caicos, but there were relatively few casualties. In addition, Anguilla, French St Martin, US Virgin Islands, Puerto Rico and Cuba were affected but did not request international assistance.
- **Significant damage but few deaths**: In some of these small islands (Barbuda and Dominica in particular) nearly all the economic and social infrastructure was destroyed, so in a sense there was a very big impact on a very small number of livelihoods. For the humanitarian community in particular, but also for UNDP, this posed the challenge of deciding what is a proportionate response.
- **Working in upper-middle and high-income countries**: Four of the five UNDP target countries/territories are high-income countries. This has a few important consequences for aid eligibility. First of all, of the five, only Dominica is eligible for World Bank concessional lending (and even Dominica is recognized as an exceptional case and eligible only for IDA-IBRD blended financing). Secondly, only Antigua and Barbuda and Dominica meet the OECD-DAC threshold for ODA spending (this affects donors differently depending upon their domestic legislation and policies). Beyond these technical questions, donors are attentive to perceptions of their publics that upper-middle or high-income countries are not as relatively needy as others, particularly if they are generally seen as luxury tourist destinations and/or tax havens. Offsetting these perceptions are others that argue that small island developing states (SIDS) have development imperatives (remoteness, limited natural resources, lack of economies of scale, unequal wealth distribution, indebtedness) and special vulnerabilities (economic and climate shocks in particular) that justify their treatment as developing countries. The UN itself is a leading champion of the case for support to SIDS, and hosts a number of intergovernmental fora and support mechanisms with the goal of supporting SIDS. Early in the response, the RBLAC Director stressed the need to “walk the talk” when it comes to supporting SIDS.
- **Working in territories that are not sovereign nations**: Three of the target countries/territories are indeed not countries but territories, governed at some level and with varying degrees of autonomy by Netherlands (Sint Maarten) or the UK (BVI and TCI). This not only compounded the question of aid eligibility, but added the further complexity that the universal and initial assumption was that primary responsibility for assisting these distressed islands lay with their governing countries (as indeed France took full responsibility for assisting the French half of the island of St Martin). Determining what should be the role of the international community relative to the roles of the UK and Netherlands took some time at the outset of the response and led to some delays and coordination confusion. Further complications stemming from this territorial status are that only two of the five are CARICOM member countries (Antigua & Barbuda and Dominica) and two are associate members (BVI and TCI). Sint Maarten does not have any status with the CARICOM, which has the consequence that Sint Maarten is not eligible for Caribbean Development Bank (CDB) lending.

All three territories are characterised by significant populations of undocumented migrants and workers, mostly employed at the low end of the tourism industry. This population is inherently vulnerable and was among the most affected by the hurricanes, since they had the most precarious

- **Capacity constraints and absorption:** Flowing from the development *problematique* of being SIDS, all five target countries/territories have severe constraints on their institutional and human resources, with limited capacity to scale up rapidly or divert people to new tasks – particularly when damage to the islands was so widespread and the effects of displacement (relatively) so severe. This was further exacerbated by the limited presence of experienced NGOs compared to usual post-disaster contexts. Partly as a consequence of these capacity constraints, implementation of planned activities has been slow. A further complicating factor in Barbuda is ongoing political tension over land tenure and land reform, while in Dominica the implementation of recovery has been slowed by the desire to first create a national recovery agency.

and Panama offices being deployed, as well as staff pulled in from other regions and (in the second wave) a number of consultants. Some of the operational difficulties experienced by UNDP resulted from the underlying lack of capacity especially in Barbados, but were compounded when members of the core operational support team were deployed and not backfilled—particularly from Panama.

4. Findings and recommendations

4.1 Key findings and lessons learned

Findings regarding coordination and management decision-making.

How effective was UNDP's internal coordination?

HQs-level inter-Bureau coordination was good

At the New York level, the Crisis Board and the Crisis Management Support Team worked as expected, with RBLAC clearly leading the response as recommended in the crisis response guidelines. Decision-making was centralised in New York for four main reasons: (a) the intense media pressure stemming from a 24/7 news cycle focused upon a region of significant interest to the US news outlets, (b) an active community of Caribbean Permanent Representatives, (c) strong engagement from the Executive Office of the Secretary-General (EOSG) in part because of (a) and (b), and finally (d) the early and ground-breaking pledge of support from China – which in turn amplified UNDP's reputational risk. If there was a weakness it was that BPPS was not sufficiently involved in some aspects of the initial programme design – a factor which also limited the relevance of the (BPPS-led) SURGE plan.

After early uncertainty, a single response narrative developed and helped focus efforts

In the early weeks of the UNDP response there were two visions of the response: one that placed emphasis upon the short-term response and on-the-ground delivery with visibility to host governments, and another that emphasised thinking ahead during the early stage to a recovery that factored in climate change and structural (economic and governance) vulnerabilities which would in turn place the region on a stronger and more sustainable footing (see discussion of the SURGE plan).

Both visions were widely understood to be valid and linked, and by the beginning of October they had been combined into a single narrative that can be summarised as “a short-term emphasis on the “roofing value chain” provides the key entry point (“foot in the door”) for UNDP to establish relationships

“think of the long-term in the short term, but also think about the short-term itself” – interview

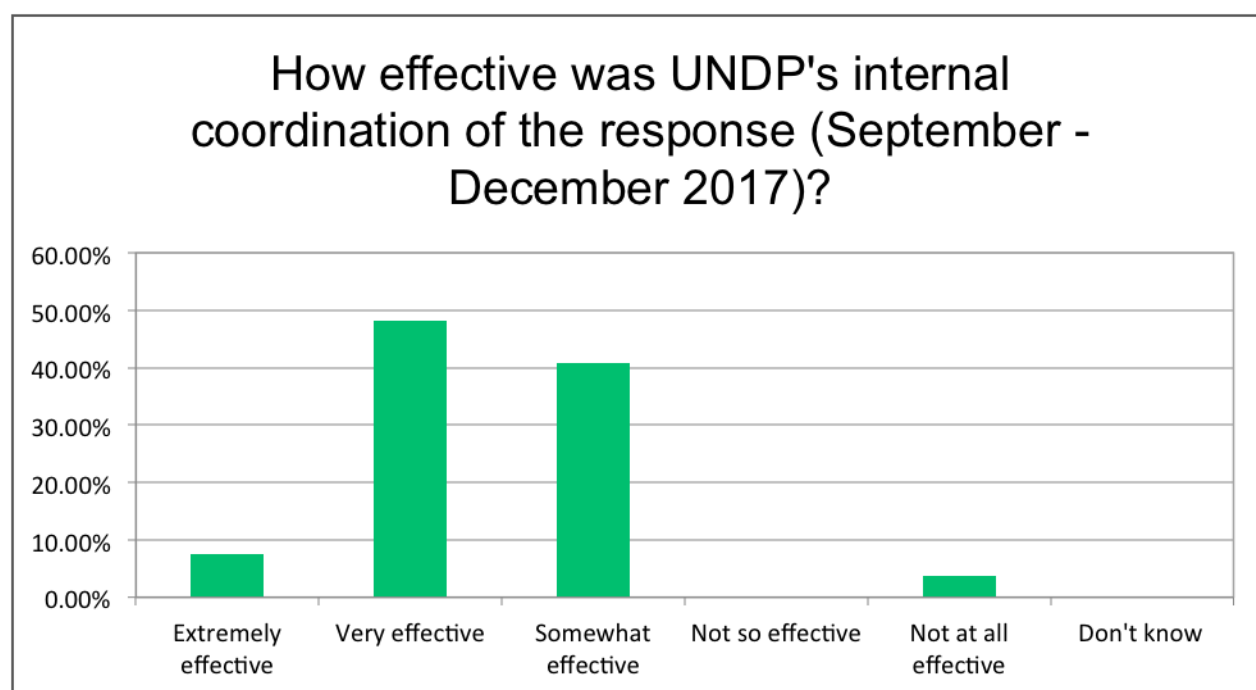
with the two most-affected countries (Dominica and Antigua & Barbuda) and builds the foundation for UNDP to engage on a range of broader downstream issues of resilient recovery.” By the time of the Donor Conference (21 November), the longer-term vision of climate resilient recovery was front and centre.

Within RBLAC, there were coordination challenges stemming from the geography of the response

Where there was more of a challenge of internal coordination was within RBLAC, which wrestled with a very challenging configuration of offices in this regional crisis. Simply put, management decision-making was centralised in New York, regional programming authority and many operational support functions were in Panama, field coordination, local donor relations and some aspects of finance and procurement were managed in three separate multi-country offices (each with an RC), and operations took place in five small

island states or territories each without an established UNDP presence. This led to situations where decisions made in one location did not always connect to all the actors necessary for smooth implementation, and bottlenecks in one office or another hindered implementation in other parts of the response. This is discussed in more detail below.

Two particular challenges of external coordination were the relationship with ECLAC over the PDNA/DALA, and to a lesser extent between UNDP and the humanitarian sectors/clusters in the field. These are also both discussed below.



How timely and efficient was UNDP's management and decision-making during the response?

UNDP senior management went “all-in,” and this set the tone and pace of the whole response

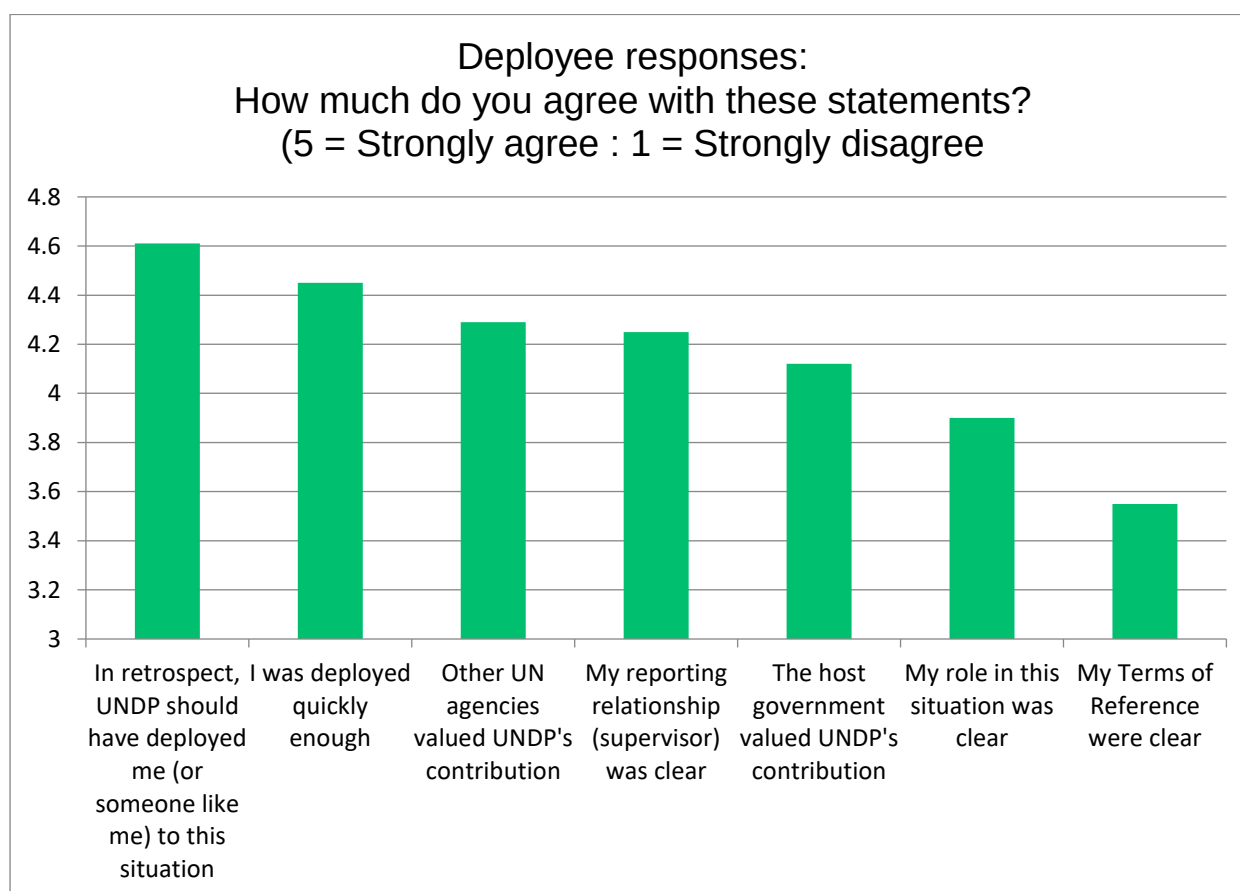
For a number of reasons outlined earlier, senior management determined at the outset that this crisis would be a top priority and acted accordingly in terms of management attention and political will, allocation of key human resources in HQs and in the field, and allocation of scarce financial resources. In particular, the creation of a small, strong and dedicated core team around the Regional Director was very effective in maintaining momentum. Having a single RBLAC (desk) focal point was seen as most useful.

Rapid deployments were signaled by all stakeholders as a UNDP strength

If there was one thing on which all stakeholders agree, it is that UNDP deployed capable and experienced people quickly. First responders were deployed within a few days (some were pre-deployed or attached to UNDAC teams), and were followed up with a second wave of early recovery advisors after the initial few weeks. Altogether, an astonishing 24 deployments were made to 7 locations, supplemented by locally-hired consultants and contractors. Deployments from within RBLAC were a key part of this, although in some instances deployed staff were not backfilled thereby leaving short-term operational gaps (especially in Panama and in Barbados) that created other bottlenecks.

The observations made by employees in response to the online survey are shown below.

In interviews, employees noted that one aspect of their deployments that could have been better, was more of a sense of community. In the end, most employees felt quite isolated, and there could have been a mechanism to facilitate exchange, lesson-learning and mutual support between them.



Regarding the lowest-scoring item of the survey – lack of clear TORs – CRU is aware that there will rarely be a solid ToR finalised prior to deployment, and recommends that country teams work with COs/RBs to get as close to one as possible, and subsequently liaise with the employees within 1-2 weeks of deployment to ensure the TORs have been updated in consultation with the CO.

Early decisions on PDNAs positioned UNDP well within the responses and with host governments

The two PDNAs (Dominica and Antigua & Barbuda) were led by the World Bank (with support and participation by UNDP), well-regarded by all, and provided a solid foundation for general needs assessment as well as for the donor conference. But PDNAs are not in themselves recovery plans, and detailed recovery planning is still under way using different approaches: in Dominica this is tied up with the creation of a national recovery agency (CREAD), and in Antigua & Barbuda this is tied up in the pressure-cooker politics of long-term development plans for Barbuda. Beyond the framing of appealing and pledging, the PDNA was likely a major factor in unlocking World Bank lending to Dominica (Antigua declined the loan terms offered), but it is too early to conclude if the PDNAs will be used to guide specific recovery plans.

Recommendation to CRU:

Consider providing supplementary UNDAC training to selected “highly likely” first responders, and support their more systematic deployment into UNDAC teams

Recommendation to RBLAC:

In conjunction with others, notably UNWOMEN and the statistical agencies of the region, improve the quantity and availability of country-specific data on women and girls in the Caribbean region, with special attention to factors affecting equality and vulnerability

But the PDNAs themselves were weak in their social/gender analysis

Both PDNAs were supported by dedicated gender expertise and have chapters on gender equality, despite these efforts gender (and to a lesser extent social dimensions) were not well-integrated across the different sectors of the PDNAs. This seems to be due to a combination of three factors: (1) weak underlying census, demographic and social data in these countries (poor social/gender baselines), (2) an infrastructure/economic bias on the part of team members (which were guided by host governments and the World Bank, and which reportedly limited the space for the gender team member voices to be heard), and (3) a general under-recognition of the systemic inequalities facing women and girls in this region, well-captured in UNDP's 2015 Caribbean Multi-Country Assessment.

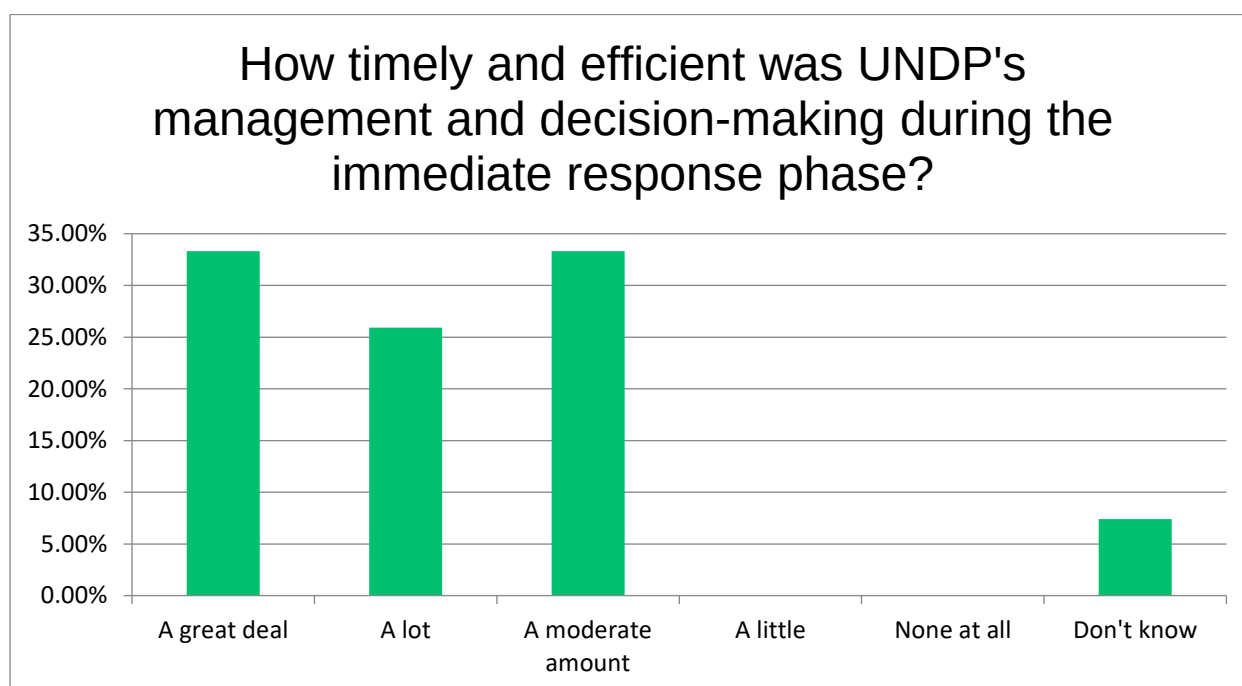
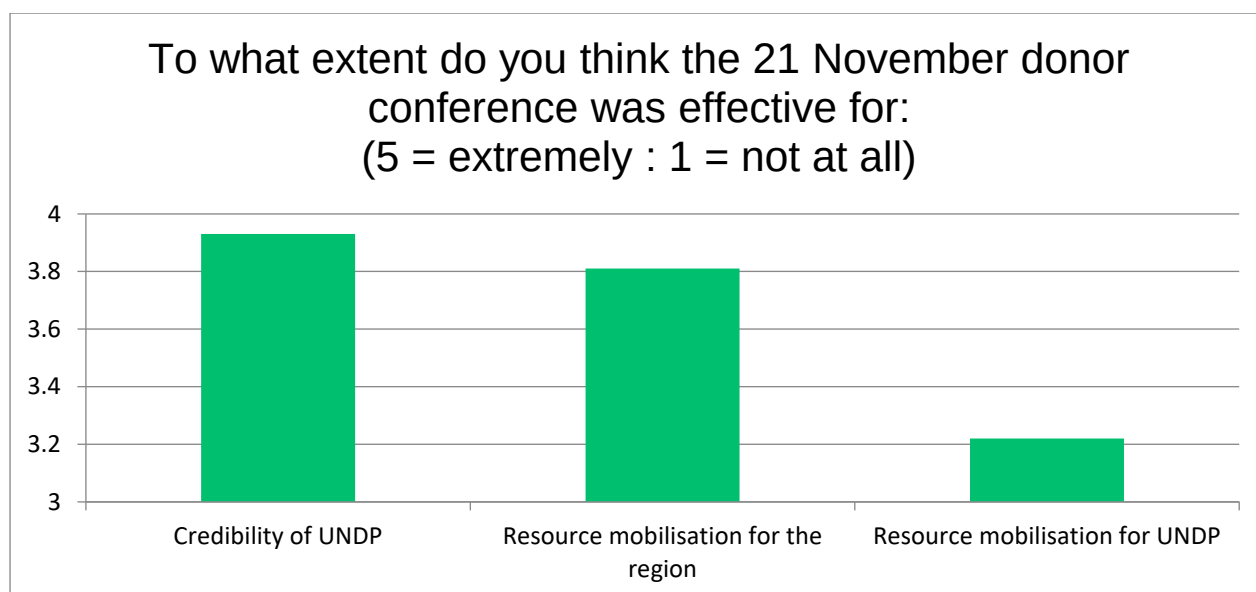
The continuing competition between ECLAC (DALA) and UNDP/World Bank/EU (PDNA) methodologies continues to place host governments in a most uncomfortable position and wastes resources as governments invest in one approach or the other, and then have to retrain or re-tool depending on which methodology is to be used in any given situation. In the end there was a practical division of labour in this region, as the three territories followed the ECLAC DALA methodology, and the two countries (eligible for World Bank and donor funding) followed the PDNA methodology.

Recommendation to RBLAC and BPPS:

Re-engage with ECLAC to resolve the interagency competition over PDNAs and DALAs. Consider developing a single joint methodology, or an institutional division of labour, or country-specific agreements on which methodology to apply after a crisis, or an understanding regarding which methodology is more appropriate in which types of crisis

An early decision on the Donor Conference was also key to its success

The 21 November Donor Conference was widely regarded as a success and well-timed, although some in the humanitarian community felt that it undermined the concurrent humanitarian appeal. With a full slate of Heads of State as well as the Secretaries-General of the UN and CARICOM, it attracted an unprecedented amount of international and donor attention to the CARICOM region, and generated a substantial \$2.3 billion of pledges (although these were, as is often the case, a mix of loans, debt relief, recycled grants, and rather few new grants). The largest pledge by far was from the Netherlands for its own territory (Sint Maarten), and follow-up to the Donor Conference is continuing as the MCO in Barbados is tracking this closely and maintains pressure on the pledging donors to deliver. The conference stood out for its emphasis upon climate resilience and for its persuasive argument for SIDS to be eligible for concessional loans, as well as a for its encouragement of a wider range of innovative financing instruments such as debt swaps, blue and green bonds, and reduced remittance transfer costs. From UNDP's viewpoint a key feature was that the conference elevated the relationship between UNDP and CARICOM to a new strategic level.



How effective were UNDP's communications and resource mobilization

In addition to CARICOM, UNDP has established important strategic partnerships with China and CDB

This response was characterized by the forging of three important and strategic partnerships for UNDP, partnerships that themselves might end up being among the most important long-term results. The first and most important was with China, which was here partnering with UNDP for the first time. China made a very early commitment to provide funding for housing – a commitment that had two profound effects upon the response. The first was that the reputational risk of failure in this highly visible and somewhat experimental donor arrangement became a major driver of the HQs-centred management approach, and of corporate communications (see below). The second is that the Chinese commitment to provide roofing shaped the entire UNDP response and led to the UNDP using roofing/housing as the entry point to early recovery.

Arguably, if China had pledged funding for debris management (which by the way is severely lagging throughout the response), then debris management might have been the entry point to early recovery (as it was in Haiti).

A second new strategic partnership was with the CDB. In the long run, in middle and high-income countries, a comparative advantage for UNDP could be to serve as the implementing agency of technical assistance projects associated with Multilateral Development Bank (MDB) loans. This model is already pursued with the World Bank in some contexts (although the two institutions are also occasionally in competition as the managers of national recovery trust funds), and here a similar relationship was piloted and then taken to scale with the CDB in the British Virgin Islands, where UNDP is receiving approximately \$1.3 million/year to provide the technical assistance component of a 3-year \$65 million CDB loan.

The strategic partnership with CARICOM is discussed above. In addition, through this response UNDP has started a promising relationship with Engineers without Borders. If there has been a partnership disappointment coming out of this response, it is that UNDP did not (at least not yet) manage to land a substantial and lasting relationship with the World Bank.

Communications staff were deployed or hired locally, but seemed to lack focus

To supplement the small communications team in HQs, additional staff for Dominica and Antigua were either deployed (UNV) or hired locally, with significant delays and gaps. The result of these deployments has been a supply of quality images for UNDP's social media streams, and a particular highlight upon the China project (both in social media and in regular factsheet updates). However, beyond the recognition of China's contribution, there seems to be little focus to the communications, and communications strategies in HQs and in the field were drafted but reportedly not finalised. In particular, it is not really clear if the overall goal of communications activities is to draw global attention to the recovery needs of the region, to position UNDP as a strategic partner (with host governments and new donors), to raise funds for UNDP from conventional donors, or to account to existing donors for performance.

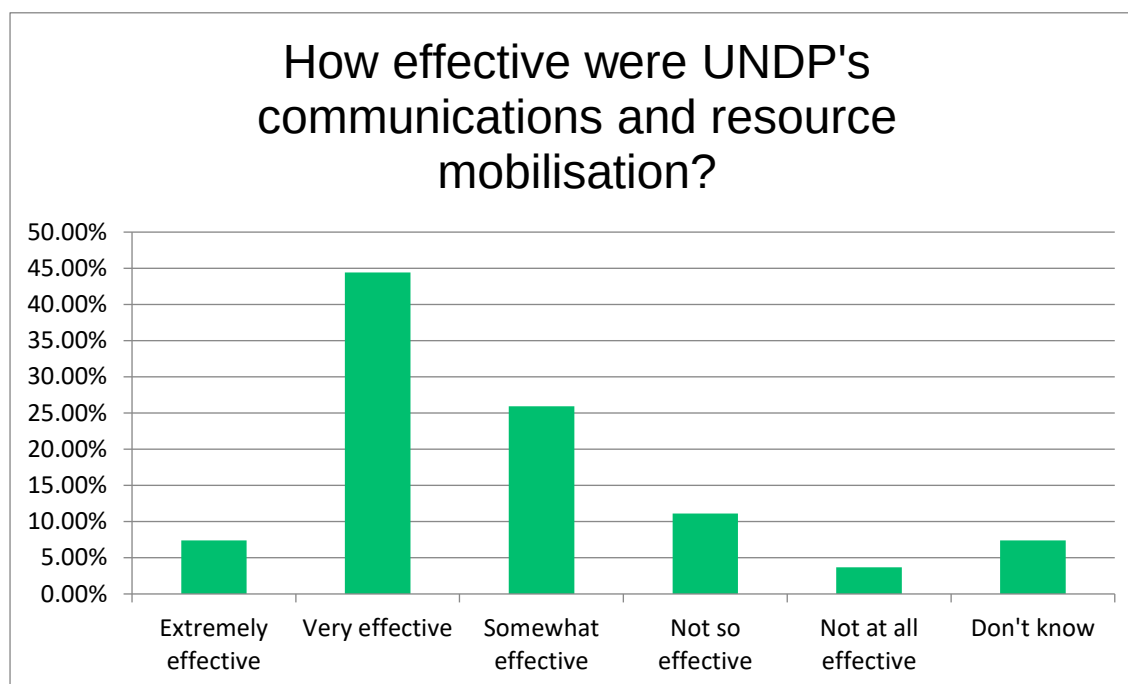
Resource mobilisation has been relatively successful

All in all, in addition to UNDP internal allocations and \$600,000 of CERF funding, UNDP has (so far) attracted about \$10 million of external funding for recovery in Antigua & Barbuda (of which \$2 million has already been received for the China project), and about \$12.0 million for recovery in Dominica. This is a good start, but it falls far short of the amounts that were anticipated in the Business Case, which was premised upon major contributions from the World Bank.

There is a very high cost per beneficiary of the Barbuda and Dominica programmes

Beyond the amounts of resources obtained, there is a question that UNDP needs to ask itself about the opportunity cost of so much effort in Dominica and Barbuda, particularly in Barbuda. In Barbuda, there are approximately 1,000 houses to repair or rebuild, for a population in the entire island of less than 2,000. Without doubt the people of Barbuda are in dire need as their housing stock is almost totally destroyed – but nevertheless this entire UNDP “country” programme is for the equivalent of a small village. To be more precise, the sum total of UNDP's efforts in the first 10 months consist of providing the roofing materials for 250 houses, at an average gross cost (logistics included) of \$8,000 per roof or (given the population of island and the number of houses) approximately \$4,000 per person. This is a very high cost per beneficiary by any measurement of a humanitarian or development project. The rationale for continuing to work in Dominica is somewhat stronger, as the country itself is poorer, the number of affected buildings and people is much higher, and the government is more welcoming – but nevertheless, the cost per beneficiary in Dominica is still high. In both cases, after the initial investments from UNDP in the crisis response and in the office structure for the Business Case period, funding has been provided by external donors. There is an argument here that the level of UNDP engagement in high cost-per-beneficiary crisis contexts – where donor country bilateral political interests can be a major factor - should be determined by the willingness of those donors to pay for it.

Survey respondent views on the effectiveness of resource mobilisation and communications are shown in the graph below.



Findings regarding Field Office configuration

What is the best way to organize and provide support for crisis response when a single UNDP office is responsible for several countries/territories?

The role of the Panama Hub was not well-defined

As explained earlier, UNDP's response was firmly led from New York because of the intensity and gravity of issue and relationship management in HQs. This effectively displaced the normal regional coordinating functions of the Panama Regional Hub when a UNDP programme spills over the boundaries of three UNDP sub-regions. Panama's operational support functions were further diluted when operational decisions were made between New York and Barbados without Panama being fully informed (in part this was a consequence of the China project being managed from Panama but only involving one Multi-Country Office (MCO) in Barbados), and finally there were some Panama capacity constraints when the key focal point in Panama was deployed to the field and not properly backstopped.

Recommendation to RBX:

On a region-specific basis (because regional structures are so asymmetrical across UNDP), clarify in advance what would be the roles of the Regional Hubs in supporting a crisis response, and ensure that the Hubs have the required capacity - or a prearrangement to acquire support in a crisis

When deploying people from the Regional Hub into a crisis situation, ensure that the Regional Hub can backfill those functions that are essential to support the crisis response

Barbados MCO could have played a greater role but lacked capacity

“Who should coordinate what” when UNDP is facing a crisis across several countries depends upon the unique features of the situation – and it should be determined on a case-by-case basis. What might have worked better in this response might not apply to a response in a similar region such as the South Pacific. In this particular case, the crisis unfolded in stages during which logical decisions were made in a certain sequence (particularly the early decision – before Maria struck Dominica - to treat the crisis as a regional crisis) but which eventually left arrangements mismatched to the final geometry of the response. The prevailing view of most interviewees is that, in retrospect, the Barbados office should have managed the China project (both countries were inside Barbados’s area of responsibility), but to do so the Barbados MCO would have needed substantially more staff in management and support functions, and possibly even a separate team as was eventually created through the Business Case. Absent this capacity – the role of managing the China project defaulted to Panama. Similarly in retrospect, since the Jamaica MCO had no functional relationship with TCI, and the Trinidad & Tobago MCO likewise had little relationship with Sint Maarten, it would have been more efficient and would have streamlined decision-making if the responsibility for both TCI and Sint Maarten had been temporarily transferred to Barbados, which is also the HQs of CDEMA, CDB and most donor organisations, such that Barbados would have had unified responsibility for the entire response and could have been supported therein by Panama. In the same spirit, Barbados could also (have) become more specialised in SIDS and in the delicate politics of working with territories and dependencies. But for Barbados to have assumed this role would definitely have required more capacity.

Recommendation to RBLAC:

Consider setting up prior arrangements across the Caribbean region such that UNDP’s crisis response in any of the small island states or territories of the Caribbean (wherever there is not a UNDP office) should be managed from Barbados

How can UNDP best support a crisis affected country/territory where UNDP has no presence?

The relationships with all five affected islands, and especially with the territories, were dormant

Prior to the hurricanes, UNDP had small GEF programmes in Antigua and Dominica, and some technical assistance to a national development plan in Sint Maarten. Visits from the MCOs to the affected islands were rare, and with the possible exceptions of Dominica and Antigua & Barbuda (GEF) there was little relationship to build on prior to Irma. Even accreditation was weak in the three dependencies and territories, whose foreign relations are generally managed from European capitals, and which had little or no understanding of the role of UN agencies or of conventional humanitarian and development mechanisms. The UN RC in Jamaica covering TCI did not even have a travel budget allowing him to make a single visit.

UNDP did not doubt its responsibility to respond to requests for assistance from high income countries and territories

Although some individuals in UNDP briefly questioned the extent to which UNDP should engage in these high-income contexts, senior management in NY and in the field made a firm and early decision that UNDP should offer assistance to all the countries and territories affected by the hurricanes – after which the matter was not raised again. However, their varied requests for external assistance, their income levels and their territorial status did shape the nature of that offer.¹

Both Antigua and Dominica are eligible for Official Development Assistance (ODA), but their major constraint is that they are not eligible for concessional lending from the MDBs (although there is a sustained campaign to change eligibility for SIDS, and Dominica is eligible for an IDA-IBRD blend). This was a factor in the Antiguan decision to decline World Bank recovery financing – which subsequently closed off a possible avenue for downstream UNDP technical assistance linked to a Bank loan (one of the assumptions of the Business Case).

The three territories are not eligible for ODA, but UNDP has access to limited non-core resources through the SIDS Trust Fund and other mechanisms that can make funds available in exceptional circumstances such as a natural disaster. However, the lack of ODA eligibility determines the nature of downstream recovery financing, which in these cases is limited to non-concessional loans from MDBs and transfers from European governing powers -- such as the \$700 million Netherlands pledge to recovery in Sint Maarten.

From a UNDP viewpoint, the high-cost environment and territorial status limited the range of UNDP's activities. While there were limited Cash-for-Work programmes in TCI and BVI, the required minimum wage was so high that very few people could participate in it. In the end, in the three territories, UNDP settled into a valued and strategic role of providing technical assistance to the Governments on aspects of recovery planning, which translated in BVI into a sustained relationship where UNDP provides technical assistance to support a CDB loan package (the relationships with TCI and Sint Maarten have now ended).

UNV deployments were hindered by the high costs of living and UNV allowance rules

UNV rules allow supplements to normal allowances to offset very high accommodation costs, but in Dominica and Antigua these were barely sufficient to attract and retain quality UNVs, and in the three very high-cost territories there were cases where UNVs simply could not be deployed despite a match of supply and demand. UNDP and UNV have reportedly started working to address this problem.

Recommendation to BMS

Continue to review with management of UNV and the mandating authority for UNV Conditions of Service whether policy changes can be introduced to provide an additional cost of living supplement and/or other compensatory measures can be provided to UNVs who are part of crisis response and recovery and who are living in exceptionally high cost-of-living environments

There were few (no?) interagency or UNDP contingency plans in place

As far as we could determine, in 2017 there had been no recent crisis preparedness or contingency planning on the part of the international community (CDEMA presumably did have plans but we did not examine them). Note that a regional UNDP crisis preparedness workshop had taken place in mid-2017 and this is

¹ Anguilla was severely affected and presented their own recovery argument at the Donor Conference – but made the very early decision to decline UN offers of support. The French part of the island of Saint Martin was entirely supported by France, and the USA took immediate responsibility for Puerto Rico and the US part of the Virgin Islands. The Dutch and British Governments mobilised significant support for their territories – in particular for the emergency response phase

Recommendation to RBLAC (and other concerned regional bureaux)

Invest in preparedness and in particular in country-specific contingency planning based on likely crisis scenarios. In this, think ahead to the special challenges of working in a location that is outside the main island (i.e. Barbuda, or maybe Nevis or Tobago, or Espiritu Santo or Savai'i)

discussed later in this report. Much work is under way in 2018 to prepare for the 2018 season, especially since so few (15-25%) of the people affected in 2017 have satisfactory shelter solutions.

Experienced first responders (and then ERAs) were deployed early, but responders in countries without a supporting office struggled to build a programming base

Across the region, the first responders were able to function effectively: for the most part they were experienced field staff accustomed to crisis response -- and their roles in the initial days were to provide real time intelligence to UNDP, to determine and coordinate UNDP's initial engagement with the countries and territories, and to provide early advice to host governments and partners.

They did not have significant programming or operational responsibilities. In the three territories, the second-wave Early Recovery Advisors kept this advisory function and were able to operate in flexible ways.

The major response in Dominica benefited from an interagency coordinating space set up by UNDAC, which allowed agencies to work together and help each other with shared resources. UNDP's capacity in-country was further boosted by the early establishment of the CMU with an empowered in-country Team Leader, and the host government actively facilitated the response by engaging constructively.

"Always deploy administrative and logistical people with programme" – Resident Coordinator interview

However, there was no similar wave of humanitarian deployments into Antigua, nor was there a comparable welcome on the part of the host government. In addition, singular features of the Antigua & Barbuda response were that the affected island of Barbuda was small, flattened, emptied of its population (no on-island resources available at all for several weeks and very limited even after one year), it was only accessible from the capital city with irregular and costly air and sea transport, and it was in a politically antagonistic relationship with the main island as well as with the government of the day. The combination of all these factors meant that the small team assigned to build a complex programme in Barbuda had to confront multiple administrative and operational difficulties, in two locations, and with minimal support. This was already inherently difficult, but was further complicated because, in the absence of a local UN office, the staff initially deployed had to undertake all the logistical and administrative functions themselves, thereby diluting their availability and effectiveness to tackle the big issues.

Recommendation to RBX (and CRU?)

Identify and train administrative and operational staff who could be deployed into a crisis. Always and immediately deploy administrative and operations support into a new country/office which will have a significant programming role (beyond an individual advisor)

Recommendation to BMS

Develop special delegated authorities and simplified financial and procurement rules for use by ERAs setting up an operation in a location without a supporting office (Dominica, A/B). This could include simplified procedures and contract templates for purchase of good and services, generic TORs for essential support positions (office admin, driver, security guard, finance clerk), and a generic lease for temporary office or staff accommodation

Recommendation to CRU

Ensure that deployees who are expected to set up a UNDP office, especially one with programme and operations responsibilities, are provided with clear guidance on setting up an office including emergency delegated authorities for local procurement of goods and services, guidelines and authorities for temporary local staff recruitment, a field coordination guide, and a protocol on communicating with the media and with donors

Regional office staff felt they should have been deployed within their region of responsibility

Several staff from the MCOs felt that UNDP should have capitalised upon their prior knowledge of the region and their established relationships, and should have been deployed as first responders. There are no doubt good reasons to deploy staff from the Regional (or Multi-Country) Office, but at the same time the capacity and experience of the potential deployees needs to be objectively considered, as well as the displacement and weakening effect on the MCO that might be losing some its core home/back office resources to deployment and thereby creating new operational bottlenecks.

Recommendation to RBX

Deploy regional office staff with prior relationships with affected countries for either short (tactical) - or long-term (strategic) assignments if two conditions are met: (a) the deploying staff have the required capacity and experience, and (b) their normal functions are either backfilled or determined to be non-essential for the period of deployment

Programming was complicated, procurement was sub-optimal, and finances were tangled.

The configuration of roles between New York and the RO Panama, three Multi-Country Offices and five affected island states or territories was complex, and (as discussed earlier) the programming capacities and responsibilities were unevenly and in some ways not clearly distributed. As a result of this, the management and accounting of the large number of small internal UNDP contributions was challenging, as well as the management of the larger CERF contributions and the China project. The implementation of the China project took different paths in Dominica and Barbuda, largely as a result of the local institutional and partner configurations. But in both cases the procurement and delivery of the roofing materials (the heart of the China project) was slow and subject to errors. These procurement delays were signalled as one of the most significant performance challenges by most interlocutors.

What are the lessons learned from the OCHA-UNDP Crisis Management Unit in Dominica?

Creating a stand-alone country office is definitely the right thing to do

A lesson learned from Grenada in 2004, and confirmed in Dominica, is the wisdom of UNDP assigning an empowered senior field coordinator to a country experiencing a major disaster and without a UN presence. In the case of Dominica, this was framed by UNDP and OCHA New York as an innovative CMU – but, from the outside and from the field, the government and other response actors did not appreciate the innovative subtlety of an integrated CMU and tended to view it as two different components: (1) a senior and medium-term UNDP official who greatly facilitated relations with the government, working together with an experienced humanitarian coordinator from OCHA, combined with (2) a very useful shared workspace that facilitated practical inter-agency coordination. Both of these components seem to have led to a stronger and more coherent overall response, but the innovation of a CMU structure in itself was not fully appreciated.

The CMU worked because of the people, and the strong mandate

There are several factors leading to the success of the CMU: and above all the experience and cooperative attitude of its key staff, who quickly developed a pragmatic division of labour. In addition, the credibility of the office (in particular the credibility of the Team Leader) was enhanced by its dual mandates from the Prime Minister of Dominica and the UN Secretary-General, and the fact that the core team remained in place for four months provided unusual and very valuable continuity.

The CMU facilitated the linkage between response and recovery, but did not create it

Having a CMU have helped link response to recovery: it was a tangible reminder of the Prime Minister's and Secretary-General's shared desire for more integration, and there was a very key planning workshop hosted by the CMU on 10 October to plan system-wide for recovery. But it is also true that recovery was part of the response vision even before the CMU was created – beginning with the Flash Appeal and supported by increased recovery-awareness on the part of humanitarian actors. Within the response, the humanitarian and development cultures co-existed and cooperated where possible, but there were moments where it became clear that they were not fully integrated. There are perhaps two main reasons for this.

First, the TORs for the CMU were agreed by UNDP and OCHA New York. While they generally included the function of “coordinating humanitarian response and recovery efforts of the international community” they did elaborate how this would relate to the normal functions of OCHA, and did not make explicit the roles and responsibilities of the RC, OCHA in Dominica, the CMU Team Leader and UNDP locally. Furthermore, the TORs for the CMU do not seem to have been widely circulated to agencies in the field (they were circulated in Barbados and New York) with the consequence that actors in the field did not fully appreciate the integrating purpose of the CMU.

Recommendation to CRU

In a future CMU: (a) be more explicit about roles and reporting relationships; (b) ensure the mandate stems from the UNDG/IASC and is fully accepted by all development and humanitarian stakeholders; and (c) make the mandate public

Second, and despite valiant efforts by actors involved, there was no known precedent or guidance for joint analysis and collective outcomes for the CMU to use as the basis for organising itself.² Instead, a set of common objectives were developed, but not soon enough to shape the first year of response and recovery

² OCHA has developed guidance on NWoW with a section on collective outcomes, which considers these to be in a 3-5 year timeframe. That might be appropriate for some situations and particularly protracted crises, but is not the timeframe for most sudden onset crises. After Haiyan, the Nepal earthquake, and hurricanes Matthew, Irma and Maria, the humanitarian timeframe was limited to 3-12 months

work. The end result of these factors, in particular the absence of a single unified command structure and collective outcomes, was that the humanitarian system in Dominica assumed its customary shape of humanitarian clusters/sectors coordinated by OCHA and framed by a Flash Appeal. Meanwhile, UNDP also worked in the way it often does, coordinating an early recovery sector (that in this case focused upon housing and to a much lesser extent on debris management and livelihoods), while it developed and implemented its own recovery programming portfolio.

UNDP missed several opportunities to work closely with others on joined-up approaches

Notwithstanding the overall success of UNDP's work in Dominica, which included a wise decision to

Recommendation to CRU

Work more, and with other key institutions, to define concretely what “joint analysis” and “collective outcomes” mean, how to determine the appropriate time frame (3 months, 6 months one year, two years?) taking into account the nature of the crisis and local capacities, and how they can be developed in the heat of a crisis

implement Cash-for-Work through the existing government internship programme known as the National Employment Programme (NEP), there were two ways in which UNDP could have worked smarter with their humanitarian counterparts. One is in the planning and execution of the BDA (see separate section on the BDA), which was implemented without full coordination with the shelter community and in particular without being linked to the VNA. The second is in the working of the Early Recovery, Food Security/Livelihood and Shelter sectors. As far as we can tell,³ the Early Recovery sector was very focused upon UNDP's own response to the crisis, and consisted primarily of their work on the BDA and implementation of the China roofing project, and secondarily upon the well-regarded Cash-for-Work programme through the NEP. UNDP did participate in the meetings of the Shelter sector (and later also the Food Security and Livelihoods sector) and shared information in particular on the plans and implementation of the PDNA and the Donor Conference, but their work on the BDA does not seem to have been fully connected to the work of the humanitarian community on household needs assessment, shelter or livelihoods/cash transfers. To some extent this is understandable – the shelter cluster's initial focus was upon emergency shelter (tarps and tents) which is far from UNDP's domain. However, as time went on and the shelter sector turned its attention to more durable aspects of shelter, UNDP should have moved its housing work under the umbrella of the Shelter sector – as they did eventually when the China project came onstream, at which point UNDP/China's roofing materials became a valued input into the broader housing programme of the Shelter cluster members.

Conclusion: the CMU model as tested in Dominica is not inherently replicable

While we do believe that the CMU model should be used again in similar situations, especially where there is a major response in a country without UN presence (and maybe even in situations where there is a UN development presence but where a special coordination unit would help focus response and recovery in a sudden onset crisis), the model would need to be improved. Elements of improvement, especially after RC system reform and the separation of the roles of UN RC from UNDP RR, would be (a) ensure that the CMU leadership is mandated by the Joint Steering Committee (which does not assume that UNDP would always

³ There are no Early Recovery sector records among the 200 emergency response documents on the OCHA website, and none were provided by UNDP

fulfil this role), (b) clearer understanding between UNDP and OCHA on the roles and boundaries of each organisation, and consideration of the principle that the leadership of the CMU would convert from OCHA to UNDP at the point where recovery (present since the beginning) “takes over” from emergency response, (c) more explicit and broadly-shared TORs that enable stakeholders from across the spectrum to get onto the same page, and (d) a greater effort to develop collective outcomes at the outset. In addition, it will be critical to ensure that there is complementarity and fit between UNDP and OCHA leadership in the field (as was the case in Dominica).

Recommendation to CRU

Continue the experiment of the CMU with refinements, develop beforehand a model TOR that can be quickly adapted to context. Consider a model for the CMU that can also be applicable to situations where there is already a UN presence but where there is a case for stand-alone coordinating hub (for example where UN agency presence is too light or too development-focused to be able to scale up and shift gears quickly)

Findings regarding Relevance

How relevant was the outcome of the Building Damage Assessment (BDA) to Government’s decision making on reconstruction and recovery?

The early decision by China to allocate funding to UNDP for roofing defined UNDP’s response

Shortly after China declared its contribution to UNDP for roofing, UNDP management concluded that the best entry point to a “Building Back Better” comprehensive recovery after these hurricanes would be to focus on the “roofing value chain,” meaning the institutional reforms and capacity development required for resilient housing in the region. This included elements of needs assessment, urban planning, government capacity-building, technical assistance centres providing practical advice to tradespersons, building codes, housing design, and of course also roofing material. For UNDP, roofing became the “foot in the door” allowing UNDP to work at the system level on resilience. And a major lesson learned here is that, deliberately or in this case probably unconsciously, an early “signature” donor can have significant influence over the shape of a recovery programme.⁴

The Building Damage Assessment tool is widely regarded as a singular success for UNDP

A key component of the roofing value chain was the Building Damage Assessment. Developing and implementing the BDA was a remarkable enterprise, involving hundreds of people (mostly volunteers) working in difficult conditions, the creation of two new strategic partnerships with Engineers without Borders and Microsoft which also reduced the costs, and substantial efforts against tight deadlines to resolve technical difficulties related to the poor quality tablets and glitchy software. The result was the rapid and low-cost collection of a massive amount of geo-localised digital data that contains housing census data that was not previously available in the country, is useful for immediate response (i.e. planning and implementing roofing/housing programmes) as well as for evidence-based recovery planning, and has much downstream potential (i.e. urban/land use planning, land registry, census), all of which is welcomed by both governments but especially Dominica. The BDA was complemented by important work on building standards that should have lasting benefit.

The BDA does however have its technical weaknesses, which UNDP is keen to address

⁴ This level of influence could become a risk factor for UNDP if the domain of donor interest and available funding pushes UNDP into technical areas in which it has limited expertise

Apart from the software licensing cost, quality and access difficulties related to the proprietary software, the main weakness of the BDA is that it did not capture vulnerability data on the occupants that could be used for priority-setting and targeting, or the mobile phone numbers of the occupants that could be used to complete data afterwards. UNDP is well aware of these weaknesses and intends to cover them in version 2.0.

The BDA was not developed with full collaboration with humanitarian stakeholders

The BDA was developed by UNDP in direct response to an urgent request from the Ministry of Housing. It was presented at a coordination meeting in Dominica in October, but received little feedback at that time. Shortly afterwards, the BDA was rolled out in Dominica on 26 October and in Barbuda on 6 November. There is no easy way to determine exactly what kind and level of data to collect in a survey instrument like this – and it would be hard to develop a tool that satisfies all users (technical and social, government and NGO, short-term users and long-term users). Nevertheless, in order to increase the prospects of it being fully used, it is important to move beyond presentation of a developed tool, and instead to actively develop the instrument together with stakeholders and especially the end users. In Dominica, the BDA took place separately from a comprehensive WFP-led Vulnerability and Needs Assessment (VNA),⁵ with missed opportunities for connecting the datasets in powerful ways.

Recommendation to CRU

Where there is a humanitarian coordination mechanism (as in Dominica) all comprehensive surveys should be managed through the Inter Sector Coordination Group to ensure that all opportunities for synergy are maximised

The full potential of the BDA has not yet been realised

In the end, the BDA is effective for mapping and calculating the needs for roofing and housing, and it definitely fulfilled UNDP's short-term needs of estimating quantities for UNDP's procurement of roofing materials, but it was not widely used for setting priorities across the whole response. In Antigua & Barbuda the Government is using the damage categorisation data from the BDA as a recovery planning baseline. In Dominica, the Government is using the BDA as a new national baseline for settlement planning and even for the designation of municipal boundaries, and sees the BDA as a tool for tracking the overall progress of recovery. Also in Dominica, the humanitarian community uses the overall map generated by the BDA as their basis for visualising the distribution and severity of damage, and the World Bank reportedly intends to use the BDA as the basis for planning their big new housing programme.⁶ All of this uses the highest-level data captured by the BDA (the map and the assessment of housing damage) but little of the detailed data. In Dominica the more detailed priority-setting of housing recovery was governed by the VNA, and the organisations actually doing the repair work (some of which are using China project materials) all do their own detailed site assessments in order to scope and plan their specific work.⁷ In addition, shelter agencies still report that access to the BDA data (owned by Government) is difficult and often only partial data is provided. In Antigua & Barbuda, the government implemented a separate process of household assessment, including the ownership, social and economic data needed to set rebuild priorities.⁸

⁵ The VNA did include the BDA as one of its input parameters for shelter, and both the BDA and VNA were discussed at interagency meetings, but UNDP does not seem to have helped shape the VNA to allow the connection between the two tools. UNDP did later analyse the potential for linkages and concluded that it was not possible to link the databases given the absence of a unique identifier in Dominica

⁶ Since the BDAs took place after the PDNAs, they did not directly inform the PDNAs, although the Dominica BDA is likely to inform the World Bank housing programme there

⁷ This is expected – the BDA was not intended for the planning and costing of detailed household-level repairs

⁸ Because of complex local politics, there is some question as to whether the Government is encouraging Barbudans to build back at all – as opposed to building something different – which is a further reason why it is ambiguous whether the Government is interested in using the pre-hurricane housing data

Further work to refine the BDA should be carried out together with the Information Management team of the Global Shelter Cluster

If UNDP intends to continue work on housing after sudden-onset natural disasters, and (despite the success of the China project) it is not clear that this is a long-term comparative advantage for UNDP, then it is imperative that UNDP work together with the community of agencies already well advanced in developing building damage assessment tools. The Global Shelter Cluster has conducted over 25 assessments in 16 countries, generally uses open source software (KoBo toolbox and ODK) that has the same functionality as the Microsoft package, and that has already been widely tested and used. For an example see the extensive package of methodologies, forms and tools used by the GSC in the 2015 Nepal earthquake response monitoring assessment – which was following a methodology similar to the one used by UNDP in the Caribbean.

Recommendation to CRU

If UNDP intends to improve the BDA tool with a version 2.0, then do this improvement design together with the GSC, see it as a global public good, use existing interagency IM/IT platforms rather than new ones, and improve its links to social data. Together with GSC, accompany the tool with a training module so GSC members and other stakeholders can use it in situations where UNDP is not working on housing. Ensure that whenever the tool is used, it is adapted by the local users to meet specific local needs, and only captures the data that is needed

How efficient were the UNDP SURGE mechanism and the Business Case approach? How did the two mechanisms complement each other/overlap?

The SURGE plan was done very early and had an emphasis on the longer-term – missed the mark UNDP has long understood that planning for recovery needs to start at the very onset of a crisis, but it is possible that the SURGE plan⁹ for this response was done too early. This question of timing is difficult. On the one hand in this response UNDP was keen to be present early and to determine its role in these somewhat confused contexts where there was little capacity or institutional prearrangement on the ground. And yet, on the other hand, this was also a situation where access was particularly difficult and the minimum information for initial planning was not available (baseline information was weak and preliminary needs assessment was not available). As a result, the SURGE mission was not able to visit the affected islands (it was limited to the three MCOs which themselves only had partial information) and it had very little useable data to work with.

“right vision but not the right timing” – interview

A second aspect of the SURGE mission is that it was not fully set up as a SURGE planning mission; it was not formally mandated by the Crisis Board, it did not contain the full team (importantly in this case, operations and communications functions were absent), and it did not follow the full SURGE process in terms of scope and depth. It is difficult to understand all the factors at play at the time these decisions were made, but with the benefit of hindsight it seems possible that some of the challenges that UNDP experienced later in the response, particularly in terms of insufficient operational support for the field and an ad hoc approach to communications, might have been anticipated and better managed if the SURGE mission had followed the full package of the SOPs.

⁹ While it was not titled a SURGE Plan, the Regional Recovery Framework effectively served as the SURGE Plan and was regarded as such by most stakeholders. See discussion below

A third feature of this SURGE mission was that the team composition had limited input from RBLAC and was weighted towards climate change and disaster risk reduction. While this was and still is agreed by everyone to be the long term need for the region and UNDP's strategic goal, the SURGE report ended up with a rather heavy emphasis on the long-term, and some critical short-term ideas were missing, in particular the two components of BDA and housing construction¹⁰ that were already being considered at the same time as the mission was under way. The SURGE report was still useful for its customary identification of immediate financing and staffing requirements, and it importantly prepared the way for a well-timed Donor Conference. But the consensus of UNDP stakeholders was that the SURGE report was a bit too early, and a bit too long-term in its emphasis, thereby not fulfilling the needs for short-term planning of the response itself.

We also heard some general reflections on SURGE planning, and three arguments seemed particularly strong. The first is that the SURGE process was designed at a time when BCPR had a full suite of programming, funding and deployment mechanisms at its disposal. Many of these are no longer available, and yet the SURGE process continues as designed for that earlier era. The second comment was that the way recovery is planned has changed in the last decade, partly as a result of cutbacks in core funding, such that the response and recovery planning process has become less about what UNDP should do, and more about what donors will fund. The third comment, was that SURGE planning needs to adapt itself to the nature of the Country Office; to the extent possible, it should work with, supplement and integrate with the Country Office rather than displace or replace it (which of course depends upon the underlying strengths and weaknesses of the country office).

Conclusion on SURGE planning

A SURGE team mission is still a fundamentally sound idea, but the SURGE tool should be more flexible. In protracted crises UNDP probably needs something else – something already closer to a Business Case, more oriented towards the role of UNDP in the medium term and focused on what UNDP needs to put in place in order to fulfil that role. In sudden onset crises, the nature of the SURGE should be shaped to the context. In some circumstances a structured report from a single senior first responder who is trusted by the organisation and knowledgeable about the region will give all the basic information management needs to decide its management approach, deployments and initial programming response (emphasis and amount). In other cases of a large complex disaster (Haiti or Nepal), UNDP might need a SURGE team as usual.¹¹ In situations like Dominica and Antigua, where there is no UNDP office, it would be wise to include a BMS member in the team to assess immediate operational issues. Whether and when to deploy a SURGE mission needs an early decision – but deployment does not need to be immediate. In some cases there might be benefit in preparing early but deploying a bit later. This decision needs to be made jointly by CRU, RBX and BPPS, and should also consider the skills mix needed for the context. This AAR would suggest that a SURGE team for a Caribbean natural disaster should as a minimum contain skills reflecting the likely sectors of short-term response, strategic understanding of long-term recovery, GEEWG, the appropriate MCO and the Regional Bureau.

The Business Case provided a good basis for closing the response chapter and framing the recovery

The Business Case for recovery from Irma and Maria was reportedly the second time this sort of mid-point strategy has been developed – the first example being the case for UNDP to build a recovery programme in Maiduguri in Nigeria. Even though a couple of aspects of the Business Case were not implemented as planned (notably the regional management position was placed in Barbados and not in Antigua, no office

¹⁰ The SURGE plan did recommend work on the longer-term aspects of building codes and technical assistance for the design of hurricane-resistant housing

¹¹ A SURGE team is intended to be technical and practical – its goal is to inform planning. This is not the same as a senior management mission that shows visible and strong corporate commitment with a view to interagency positioning and resource-mobilisation, although there might be temptations to combine the two

was set up in BVI and the downstream financing has not materialised at the scale anticipated), the Business Case has several singular benefits that merit being replicated in future.

First among these, is that it provides a mechanism for UNDP itself to transition from the response phase (where CRU is heavily involved) to the recovery phase (where CRU is absent). In many situations, particularly sudden onset natural disasters which often follow a more linear path from response to recovery than protracted and conflict situations, this could coincide with the moment where OCHA withdraws from an operation and “hands over” to development actors. In these situations a Business Case could be part of a larger humanitarian and development community-wide reflection (in NWoW mode) about the optimal structures for coordinating recovery.

Secondly, a Business Case such as the one done for Irma and Maria ensures that the planning of the office configuration, staffing and financing for the recovery stage is done deliberately and at the Agency level rather than (as is sometimes the case) left to country offices to muddle through as best they can, usually with inflated expectations and insufficient resources. As part of this, there is a benefit in having the Business Case prepared by someone who knows the organisation well but who comes from outside the response – someone without vested interests and with the authority to conclude, for example, that realistically the enabling conditions are not in place for a major recovery programme to be built.

And third, the Business Case accommodates to the “new normal” referenced earlier, in that it actively and realistically considers what donors will fund, alongside what it is that UNDP can do. In this respect, it would be important for the Business Case owners to have an honest and high-level “eyeball-to-eyeball” exchange with key donors, to get a realistic assessment of funding prospects.

Recommendations to CRU

Conduct an assessment at the end of every major crisis response to (a) close out the response phase and deliberately plan the transition to recovery, and (b) to determine if there is a business case (including an appraisal of donor funding) for continuing a UNDP recovery programme

Make the Business Case a broader enterprise supported by humanitarian and development actors, with a view to collectively determining the role that UNDP should play in system-level coordination for recovery

Continue to have Business Cases prepared by staff from outside the response, and allow the possibility that the Business Case concludes with a no-go decision. To allow the possibility of a no-go recommendation, consider renaming it something more open like a Recovery Feasibility Analysis

Are there any suggestions for changes in the UNDP crisis response policies and tools?

Crisis packages do not seem to have been used as intended, although employees mostly knew they existed

While most employees and staff in the MCOs were aware of the crisis response packages, in only a few cases did they actually look at the online resource and actively use them to help with their advocacy and planning. As discussed earlier, the SURGE planning tools could be more flexible and adaptable to context, and the Business Case should be built up into a more systematic way of framing and managing the closure of the crisis response phase and (where conditions and resources for recovery are conducive) setting-up the institutional and funding arrangements for the recovery phase.

The BDA should not become a new crisis response package unless UNDP envisages a strategic role for the organisation in housing programmes following a natural disaster, and in that case the tool should be

developed in conjunction with the IM Working Group of the GSC and should be seen as a system-wide exercise beyond UNDP.

In situations where deployed staff have to set up a field operation (beyond an individual advisory deployment) then ensure that they are provided with adequate operational support (administration and finance, and possible logistics and procurement), and provide them with a strong pre-departure briefing package including improved guidance on setting up an office together with simplified emergency procurement rules (see earlier recommendations to CRU and BMS).

To what extent was the July 2017 Regional Workshop on Disaster Preparedness useful for the response to hurricanes Irma and Maria?

The July 2017 Regional Workshop was generally useful for providing basic awareness to UNDP staff of roles and tools for crisis response, but did not directly contribute to preparedness for Irma and Maria

Through the online survey, five people who had participated in both the July 2017 Workshop and in the Irma/Maria response indicated that the workshop covered a lot of ground in a short time, thereby raising awareness but not equipping staff to actually manage a crisis response.¹²

Survey respondents recommended that a general workshop such as this should be repeated every few years so that staff who are new to the region are brought onto the same page, and so that corporate guidance and tools are updated, but that it should be complemented in locations where there is a high probability of a sudden onset crisis by country office-specific in-depth training and preparation, based upon concrete scenarios, and considering the actual risks and configuration of each country or sub-region. Ideally, a practically-oriented training session such as this could have the elements of response plan as one of its outcomes, as well as an overview of what are the preparedness gaps that should be addressed. This is reportedly what was done at the June 2018 workshop in Barbados.

Findings regarding short vs longer-term priorities and transition from response to recovery

How relevant, efficient and effective were the main contributions of UNDP to the crisis response?

UNDP listens to the host government

In Dominica, the Government was very clear about how it valued how UNDP listens to Government, and works for the partner country's interest rather than for their institutional or sectoral interest. This responsiveness and neutrality was what set UNDP apart from other agencies.

"Very responsive, flexible, adaptive" – Government

Even in Antigua & Barbuda, where the relationship between UNDP and the host government is a more complex, the Government recognised that UNDP's neutrality was key to allowing the housing programme to proceed despite the deeply divided local political context.

¹² This was not the eventual aim of the workshop. Although the option of a focused preparedness workshop for crisis-prone country offices was considered, it was eventually decided to hold a broader and more general workshop to raise awareness

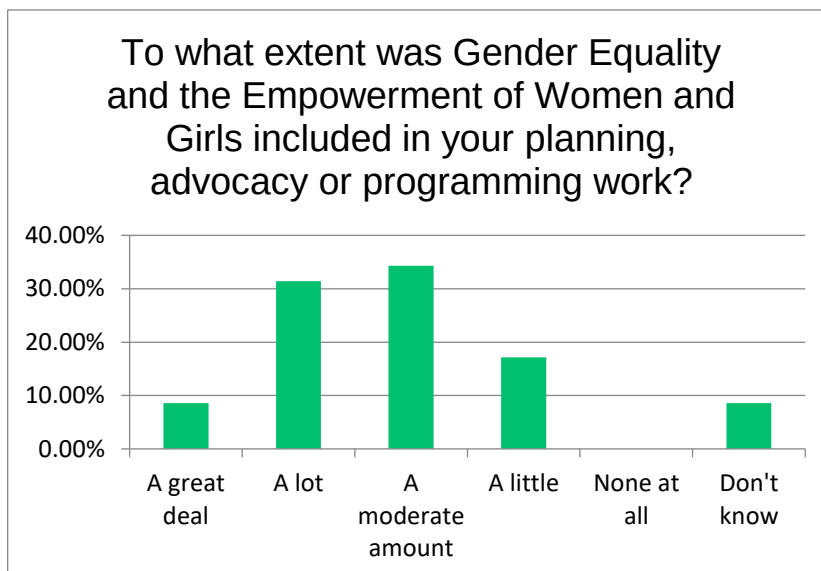
Gender Equality and the Empowerment of Women and Girls

Notwithstanding the generous self-assessment that survey respondents made of their own performance (see box), the survey comments confirm our own analysis from document review and interviews that for the most part gender equality and the empowerment of women and girls was limited to two things: (a) general statements of intent (for example in the listing of vulnerable groups), and (b) the “body count” inclusion of women in programmes and in particular in the Cash-for-Work programmes. In all fairness to UNDP, the broader responsibility for

integrating GEEWG into the recovery rests with the local and national Governments of Antigua & Barbuda and of Dominica, which are overall responsible for recovery planning and specifically for the decisions as to which families receive support for housing repairs. But UNDP could have done much more to put a gender analysis on the table.

Specifically, the project proposals prepared by UNDP were silent on social gender analysis, the PDNAs were weak on their social gender analysis (although slightly better than the DALAs which were entirely silent on gender equality), and the BDA – although it did try to capture information on whether a household was female-headed – was lacking the social dimension necessary for targeting and priority-setting. We did not find evidence that UNDP was aware of the gender differential impacts of the hurricanes, nor did we find suggestions that UNDP’s crisis response or recovery work should take into account those differentials and the opportunities presented by the recovery to redress some of the systemic inequalities in these contexts.

While we make specific recommendations in this regard (see below), we have been advised that BPPS has recently completed gender and recovery guidelines to be integrated in all crisis response packages. Furthermore, CRU intends to design the next first responder training in close collaboration with the BPPS Gender team. Finally, crisis response packages training on cash based interventions and disaster recovery planning and coordination includes GEEWG elements that will be further strengthened by integrating gender and recovery guidelines. The following recommendation therefore encourages UNDP to follow through on these existing commitments.



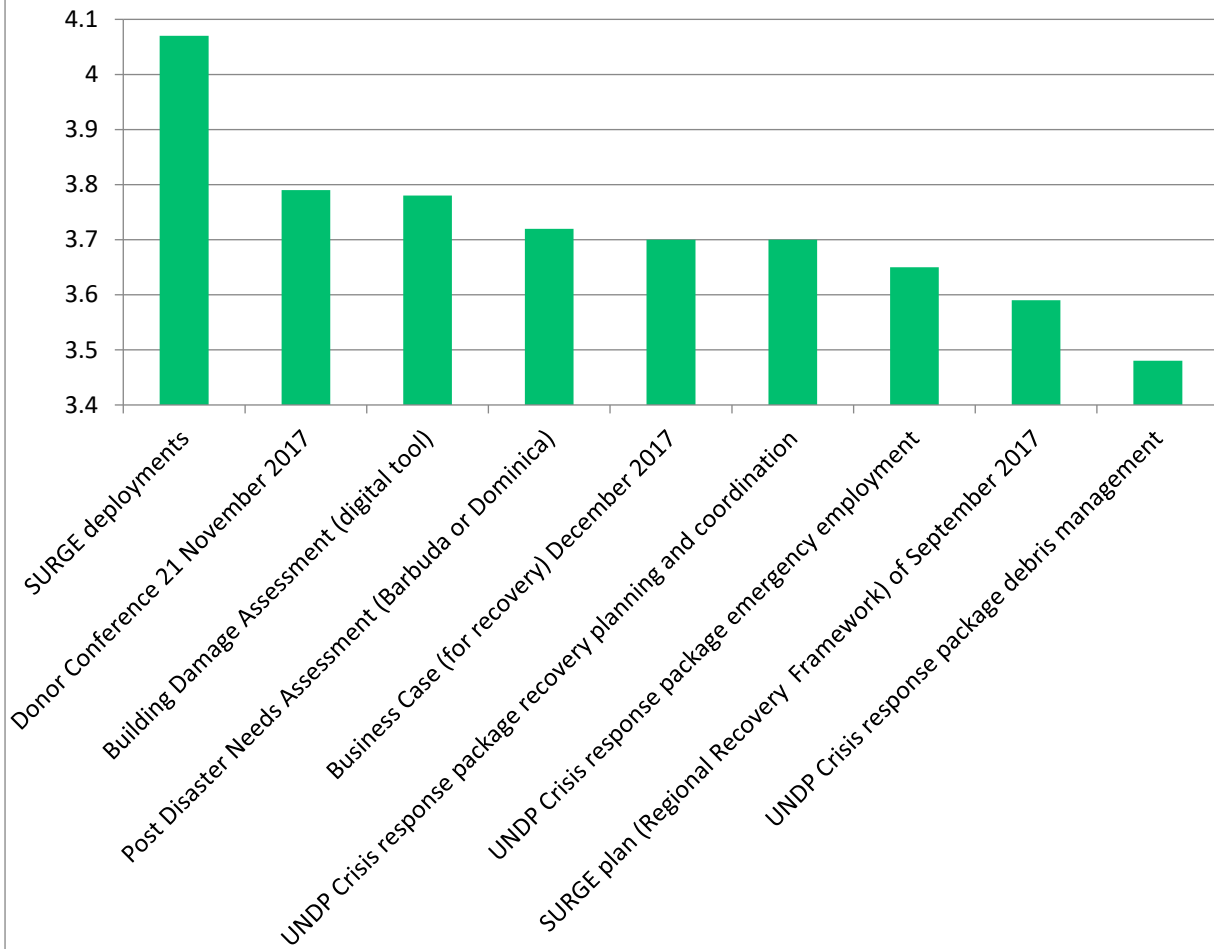
Recommendations to CRU

CRU needs to do much more on increasing awareness and capacity for GEEWG. This could include a GEEWG audit and updating of CRU guidelines, crisis packages and training programmes, specific staff training, and greater emphasis on GEEWG in SURGE planning, Business Cases and PDNAs

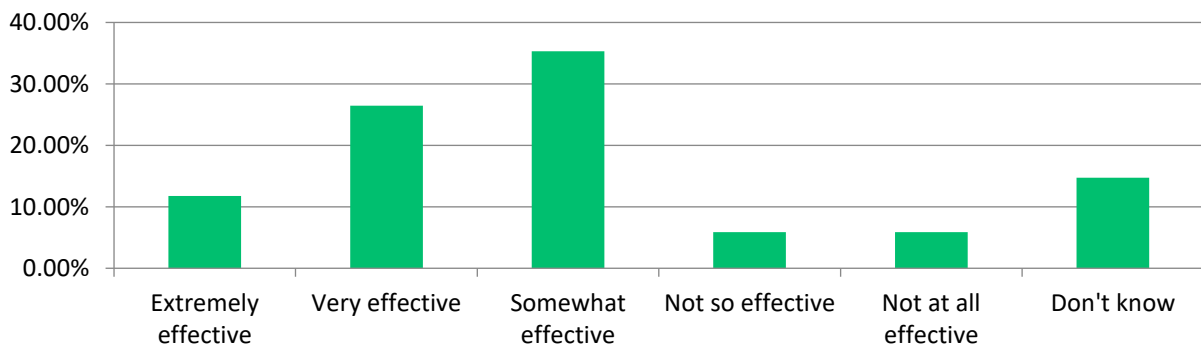
UNDP contribution	Comments on relevance, efficiency and effectiveness	
Business Case	Good instrument to frame the recovery: if expected resources did not materialise is that the fault of the BC?	Excellent, to be maintained as much as possible
First responder deployments	Rapid, capable and relevant	
Crisis Board and CMST	Excellent, but did not tackle ECLAC, and some communications with the region skipped key actors at vital moments	Excellent, with some areas for minor improvement in future
Donor Conference	Remarkable achievement, high profile, but pledges below expectations in terms of new grant pledges for the region	
ERA deployments	Good, but more support for ERAs needed, especially in Antigua	
Partnerships	Breakthrough arrangements with China, CDB and CARICOM, but did not land a strategic relationship with World Bank	
Crisis Package-Cash-for-Work	Excellent link-up with NEP in Dominica, and solid but a bit late in Barbuda. Welcome in BVI but overall insufficient for needs	
Building Damage Assessment	Good tool but should have linked to targeting, joined up with VNA, and built on GSC best practices	Good, but with significant room for improvement if these approaches are to be repeated in future
Crisis Package-Recovery Planning	Only in Dominica is there an intention to develop a comprehensive recovery plan with some UNDP support. Package itself was not visibly used	
Crisis Management Unit	Right idea, but incomplete in the execution. Some lessons here on transparency and collective outcomes for next time	
China project	Procurement delays and deficiencies, but link-up with other stakeholders on field delivery good, and donor relationship strong. So far UNDP has mostly stayed out of the beneficiary distribution politics, but this is a big risk factor for future	
PDNAs	Good exercises but weak on social-gender analysis, and did not resolve underlying competition with ECLAC	Met the needs, but some system improvements needed
SURGE plan	SURGE plan contained the appropriate long-term goals, but did not provide enough guidance on the short-term	
Support (operational) deployments	Not enough or fast enough in Barbados, Dominica, Antigua, as a result of which operations and procurement were weaker, increasing UNDP's operational and reputational risk	Did not meet the needs, room for significant improvement
External communications	Beyond reporting to China, not clear what was the overall communications strategy or if it was effective	
Gender Equality and the	There are light references to social and gender factors in the PDNAs, and there is a male/female participant count	Weak, and needs

Empowerment of Women and Girls	in the CfW programmes, but beyond that no evidence of social gender analysis or planning in any plans or programmes	addressing as a priority
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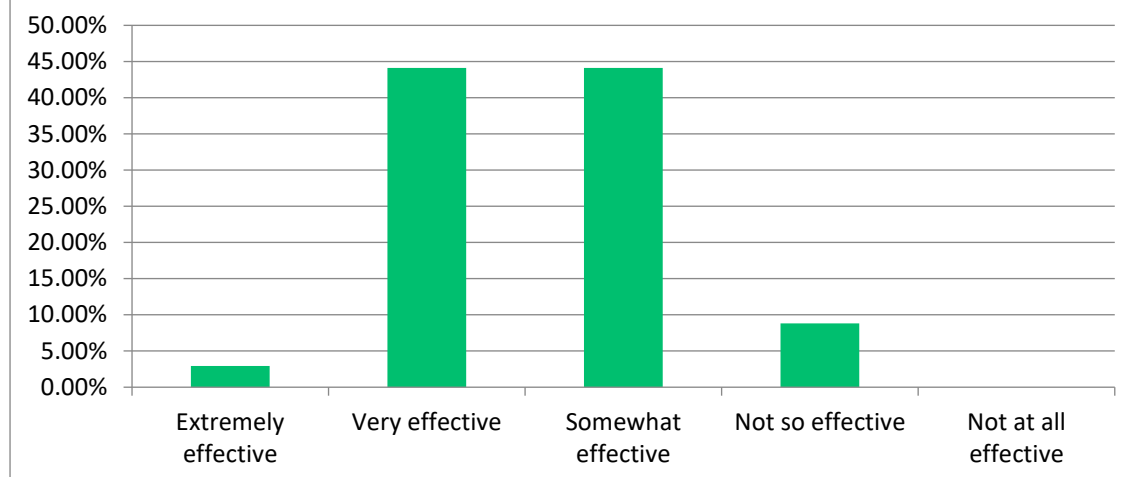
Assess the effectiveness of these UNDP crisis response tools in this crisis (5 extremely : 1 not at all)



How relevant, efficient and effective were the main contributions of UNDP to the **immediate response**?



What is your **overall assessment** of UNDP's response to hurricanes Irma and Maria?



4.2 Actionable Recommendations

Recommendations to CRU:

1. Consider providing supplementary UNDAC training to selected “highly likely” first responders, and support their more systematic deployment into UNDAC teams
2. (a) Continue the experiment of the CMU with refinements, develop beforehand a model TOR that can be quickly adapted to context. Consider a model for the CMU that can also be applicable to situations where there is already a UN presence but where there is a case for stand-alone coordinating hub (for example where UN agency presence is too light or too development-focussed to be able to scale up and shift gears quickly).
(b) In a future CMU: (i) be more explicit about roles and reporting relationships; (ii) ensure the mandate stems from the UNGD/IASC and is fully accepted by all development and humanitarian stakeholders; and (iii) make the mandate public.
3. Work more, and with other key institutions, to define concretely what “joint analysis” and “collective outcomes” mean, how to determine the appropriate time frame (3 months, 6 months one year, two years?) taking into account the nature of the crisis and local capacities, and how they can be developed in the heat of a crisis.
4. Where there is a humanitarian coordination mechanism (as in Dominica) all comprehensive surveys should be managed through the Inter Sector Coordination Group to ensure that all opportunities for synergy are maximized.
5. If UNDP intends to improve the BDA tool with a version 2.0, then do this improvement design together with the GSC, see it as a global public good, use existing interagency IM/IT platforms rather than new ones, and improve its links to social data. Together with GSC, accompany the tool with a training module so GSC members and other stakeholders can use it in situations where UNDP is not working on housing. Ensure that whenever the tool is used, it is adapted by the local users to meet specific local needs, and only captures the data that is needed.

6. (a) Conduct an assessment at the end of every major crisis response to (a) close out the response phase and deliberately plan the transition to recovery, and (b) to determine if there is a business case (including an appraisal of donor funding) for continuing a UNDP recovery programme.
- (b) Make the Business Case a broader enterprise supported by humanitarian and development actors, with a view to collectively determining the role that UNDP should play in system-level coordination for recovery
- (c) Continue to have Business Cases prepared by staff from outside the response, and allow the possibility that the Business Case concludes with a no-go decision. To allow the possibility of a no-go recommendation, consider renaming it something more open like a Recovery Feasibility Analysis.
7. Ensure that deployees who are expected to set up a UNDP office, especially one with programme and operations responsibilities, are provided with clear guidance on setting up an office including emergency delegated authorities for local procurement of goods and services, guidelines and authorities for temporary local staff recruitment, a field coordination guide, and a protocol on communicating with the media and with donors.
8. CRU needs to do much more on increasing awareness and capacity for GEEWG. This could include a GEEWG audit and updating of CRU guidelines, crisis packages and training programmes, specific staff training, and greater emphasis on GEEWG in SURGE planning, Business Cases and PDNAs.

Recommendations to RBLAC:

9. In conjunction with others, notably UNWOMEN and the statistical agencies of the region, improve the quantity and availability of country-specific data on women and girls in the Caribbean region, with special attention to factors affecting equality and vulnerability.
10. Consider setting up prior arrangements across the Caribbean region such that UNDP's crisis response in any of the small island states or territories of the Caribbean (wherever there is not a UNDP office) should be managed from Barbados.
11. UNDP should provide the mandate and the resources to the MCOs in the Caribbean region to establish the minimum relations with each of the governments in the region, including memoranda of understanding with counterpart ministries regarding UNDP's role in crisis response and recovery.
Recommendation to RBLAC (and other concerned regional bureaux)
12. Invest in preparedness and in particular in country-specific contingency planning based on likely crisis scenarios. In this, think ahead to the special challenges of working in a location that is outside the main island (i.e. Barbuda, or maybe Nevis or Tobago, or Espiritu Santo or Savai'i).

Recommendations to RBX:

13. (a) On a region-specific basis (because regional structures are so asymmetrical across UNDP), clarify in advance what would be the roles of the Regional Hubs in supporting a crisis response, and ensure that the Hubs have the required capacity - or a prearrangement to acquire support in a crisis.
- (b) When deploying people from the Regional Hub into a crisis situation, ensure that the Regional Hub can backfill those functions that are essential to support the crisis response.
14. In programming: (i) be explicit about roles of HQs, Regional Hub and CO; (ii) communicate programming decisions clearly and universally so everyone is in the loop, clearly understands who is responsible for what, and has the information and mandate needed for action; and (iii) provide more operational support (finances, procurement, logistics) as early as possible.
15. Deploy regional office staff with prior relationships with affected countries for either short (tactical) - or long-term (strategic) assignments if two conditions are met (i) the deploying staff have the required capacity and experience, and (ii) their normal functions are either backfilled or determined to be non-essential for the period of deployment.

Recommendation to RBX (and CRU?):

16. (a) Identify and train administrative and operational staff who could be deployed into a crisis.
(b) Always and immediately deploy administrative and operations support into a new country/office which will have a significant programming role (beyond an individual advisor).

Recommendation to RBLAC and BPPS:

17. Re-engage with ECLAC to resolve the interagency competition over PDNAs and DALAs. Consider developing a single joint methodology, or an institutional division of labour, or country-specific agreements on which methodology to apply after a crisis, or an understanding regarding which methodology is more appropriate in which types of crisis.

Recommendation to BERA:

18. Develop an information package/graphic that explains in simple terms to an uninitiated senior official what it is that UNDP is and does (and does not do) in crisis and recovery situations.

Recommendations to BMS:

19. Continue to review with management of UNV and the mandating authority for UNV Conditions of Service whether policy changes can be introduced to provide an additional cost of living supplement and/or other compensatory measures can be provided to UNVs who are part of crisis response and recovery and who are living in exceptionally high cost-of-living environments.
20. Develop special delegated authorities and simplified financial and procurement rules for use by ERAs setting up an operation in a location without a supporting office (Dominica, A/B). This could include simplified procedures and contract templates for purchase of good and services, generic TORs for essential support positions (office admin, driver, security guard, finance clerk), and a generic lease for temporary office or staff accommodation.

Annexes

Annex 1: After Action Review Terms of Reference

TERM OF REFERENCE

GENERAL INFORMATION

Services/Work Description:	After Action Review of UNDP Response to Irma and Maria
Project/Program Title:	UNDP's Crisis Response Unit
Post Title:	Consultant
Duty Station:	Home Based + Travel to New York and selected affected countries
Duration:	22 Working Days
Expected Start Date:	4 June

I. BACKGROUND / PROJECT DESCRIPTION

Category five hurricanes Irma and Maria struck the Caribbean¹³ in September 2017, resulting in loss of lives, displacement of large sections of the population, widespread damage and destruction to infrastructure and habitat, as well as significant economic disruption in the Caribbean.

UNDP immediately deployed first responders to support each affected country / territory to implement immediate recovery activities and, in the case of Dominica, to set-up a Crisis Management Unit to lead the international relief and recovery efforts at the request of the UN Secretary-General. A regional recovery planning mission was deployed in the affected countries to define UNDP priority areas of interventions recommending: i) immediate early recovery activities at the national level, ii) national recovery assessments, planning and programming and iii) regional engagement to strengthen longer term resilience.

First responders and SURGE staff deployed played a critical role in the early weeks of the crisis to assess needs, coordinate the response, set-up early recovery programmes and support longer term recovery planning. At the regional and global level, UNDP supported CARICOM in the organization of an international pledging conference on 21 November 2017 to enhance resilience in the region.

UNDP carries out After Action Reviews (AAR) as a structured reflection after a crisis to help the organization's identification of strengths and weaknesses, positive and negative lessons learned, ways to sustain and replicate what was done well and recognize areas for improvement. The AAR formulates actionable recommendations for improving UNDP crisis response policy and practice. Ideally an AAR takes place during the first 3-4 months of a response process.

As per the corporate accountability framework for crisis response, the Crisis Response Unit (CRU) leads the planning, coordination and dissemination of corporate AAR.

II. SCOPE OF THE WORK

The objective of this AAR is to examine the relevance, the efficiency, the effectiveness of UNDP response to the crisis in Sint Maarten, Barbados, Dominica, British Virgin Islands and Antigua and Barbuda during the period from September 2017 to December 2017. The AAR will highlight lessons learned that would help strengthen the functioning, performance and efficiency of UNDP response including: UNDPs corporate and country level programmatic and operational response; UN and interagency coordination; contribution to PDNAs and recovery processes.

The AAR will address the following primary questions:

¹³ Sint Maartens, Barbados, Dominica, British Virgin Islands and Antigua and Barbuda

How effective was UNDP's internal coordination?

How timely and efficient was UNDP's management and decision-making during the immediate response phase?

How did UNDP balance immediate recovery activities with longer term programmatic engagement?

What is the best way to organize and provide support in a UNDP multi-country office setting?

How to support a crisis affected country / territory where UNDP has no presence?

How efficient was the UNDP SURGE mechanism and the Business Case approach? How did the two mechanisms complemented each other's / overlapped?

How relevant, efficient and effective were the main contributions of UNDP to the crisis response (includes programme and operations elements) particularly with the immediate versus medium/longer term actions?

How effective was UNDP's communications and resource mobilization?

Would it be any suggestions for changes in the UNDP crisis response policies and tools?

What are the lessons learned from the OCHA-UNDP Crisis Management Unit in Dominica?

Methodology

Typically, an AAR uses mixed methods with information gathered from primary and secondary sources. This includes desk reviews of documents, key informants' interviews and focus group discussions, presentations of AAR findings with relevant stakeholders including headquarters (i.e. Central and Regional Bureaux involved), the country office and deployed personnel. When applicable, surveys can be organized to collect relevant data for the AAR.

III. EXPECTED OUTPUTS AND DELIVERABLES

Under the direct supervision of the Program Specialist (CRU Rapid Response and Preparedness Team), and in coordination with CRU Crisis Coordination Team as well as the Regional Bureau for Latin America and the Caribbean and the Country Offices, the consultant for the AAR exercise will:

1. Lead the AAR exercise from preparation to final delivery in close collaboration with CRU, the Regional Bureau and the Country Office.
2. Draft an inception report that includes an overview of the facts and events relevant to the ARR, the AAR work plan that includes timelines, final methodology and key questions, proposed table of content for the report, list of stakeholders to be interviewed, in country mission schedule, among others.
3. Participate in the UNDP crisis preparedness workshop for the Caribbean and provide insights from the inception report and collect relevant information from relevant workshop participants
4. Gather and review, with support from UNDP Crisis Response Unit, all the necessary documents related to the Global, Regional and Country level response, including relevant procedures and practices.
5. Lead the consultations processes related to the AAR, including preparatory meetings, surveys when relevant, in country visit in UNDP's country office, focus group discussions, debriefings and report presentation by liaising and coordinating with all relevant stakeholders.
6. Lead an analysis of responses collected through key informant interviews and focus group discussion based on the objective and scope, including the primary questions, of the AAR and in adherence with the methodology.
7. Produce a draft AAR report with findings and actionable recommendations¹⁴, compile and address comments that arise from the internal circulation of the draft report.

¹⁴ The recommendations will have a forward-looking view, with aim to identifying best practices and innovations that can be systematized, as well as practices that need to be avoided in the future. At the extent possible, the recommendations will also define areas for further investment and improvement in crisis response.

8. Prepare and facilitate a presentation of the AAR findings and recommendations with relevant stakeholders in the country office and in UNDP Headquarters and compile and address comments from the presentation in the AAR report.
9. Produce a final AAR report (max 30 pages) complemented by a two-pager document summarizing the key findings and recommendations, for submission to UNDP.
10. Follow up on the outcome of the UNDP crisis preparedness workshop for the Caribbean and on the AAR report recommendations and propose an action plan on preparedness for the Caribbean.

Payments under this contract will be delivery-based with the various installments being processed upon receipt of key deliverables, as follows:

Deliverables	Estimated Duration to Complete¹⁵	Percentage of full payment
- Initial data collection and consultations (online) with UNDP Country Office, the UNDP Regional Hub, and (online or in person) with UNDP New York. - Gather and review with support from UNDP Crisis Response Unit all the necessary documents related to the Global, Regional and Country level response, including relevant procedures and practices. - An inception report on the initial findings from the desk review that includes an overview of the facts and events relevant to the ARR, the AAR work plan that with timelines, final methodology and key questions, proposed table of content for the report, list of stakeholders to be interviewed, and in country mission schedule.	5 days	1st installment: 20% of full payment

¹⁵ Not binding, for consultant consideration only. The payment will be delivery based only.

Annex 2: Desk review bibliography

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Annex 3: List of people interviewed

	Name	Title	Agency/Unit	E-mail
1	Fabrizio Andreuzzi		UNDP CRU	
2	Carolina Azevedo		UNDP RBLAC	
3	Wendy Cue		UN OCHA	
4	Ana Maria Diaz		UNDP RBLAC	
5	Jessica Faieta		UNDP RBLAC	
6	Antoine Haarman		UNDP CRU	
7	Janthomas Hiemstra		UNDP Ukraine	
8	Bruno Lemarquis		UNDP CRU	
9	Deodat Maharaj		UNDP Guyana	
10	Chiara Mellucci		UNDP BPPS	
11	Joanne Persad		CDEMA	
12	Elizabeth Riley		CDEMA	
13	Kenroy Roach		UNDP RBLAC	
14	Jo Scheuer		UNDP BPPS	
15	Rae Beazer		Civil Society	
16	Aurelie Boukobza		UNDP BPPS	
17	Elizabeth Burges-Sims		CDB	
18	Claudina De Souza		Civil Society	
19	Patrice Francis		Private Sector	
20	Leroy Gore		UNDP Barbuda	
21	Henry Griffin		UNDP Barbuda	
22	Kerrie Hall		UNDP Antigua	
23	Johann Henry		UNDP Barbuda	
24	Sherrod James		Government	
25	Rohan Jarvis		Government	
26	Claude Jean		UNDP Barbuda	
27	Maureen Lance-Onyeiwu		UNDP Antigua	
28	Soraya Looby		Government	
29	Alando (Major) Michael		Government	
30	Philmore Mullin		Government	
31	Arthur Nibbs		Government (MP)	
32	Alex Piggot		Private Sector	
33	Trevor Walker		Government (MP)	
34	Devon Warner		Civil Society	
35	Paul Saunders		CDB	
36	Reshmi Theckethil		UNDP BVI	
37	Lucien Blackmoore		Government	
38	Sam Carrette		Government	
39	Marlon Clarke		UNDP Barbados	
40	Rosamund Edwards		Government	

41	Danielle Evanson		UNDP Barbados	
42	Steve Ferrol		Government	
43	Greg Grimsich		UN OCHA	
44	Emeline Honoré		Government	
45	Gloria Joseph		Government	
46	Ian King		UNDP Dominica	
47	Arun Malhotra		UNDP RBLAC	
48	Jean-Laurent Martin		UNDP Dominica	
49	Craig Nesty		UNDP Dominica	
50	Zaimis Olmos		UNDP Dominica	
51	Fitzroy Pascal		Government	
52	Luca Renda		UNDP RBLAC	
53	Marie Spaak		UN OCHA	
54	Massimiliano Tozzi		UNDP Dominica	
55	Jennie Trow		UN OCHA	
56	Jan-Willem Wegdam		IOM	
57	Simone Banister		UK	
58	Denise Blackstock		UNFPA	
59	Ugo Blanco		UNDP RBLAC	
60	Clemens Buter		PAHO	
61	Jose Legarra		European Union	
62	Alison McLean		UNWOMEN	
63	Chisa Mikami		UNDP Barbados	
64	Stephen O'Malley		UN RC Barbados	
65	Dana Van Alphen		PAHO	
66	Richard Blewitt		UN RC Trinidad	
67	Rob Duijs		UNDP consultant	
68	Barbara-Anne Krijgsman		UNDP consultant	
69	Brian Been		Government	
70	Georgina Bonin		UNDP Suva	
71	Jacinda Fairholm		UNDP RH Panama	
72	Bruno Pouezat		UN RC Jamaica	

Annex 4: Summary of interview/survey/focus group questions

1. Online survey questions:

- How timely and efficient was UNDP's management and decision-making during the immediate response phase?
- How effective were UNDP's communications and resource mobilisation?
- To what extent were Gender Equality and the Empowerment of Women and Girls included in your planning, advocacy or programming work?
- Assess the effectiveness of these UNDP crisis response tools in this crisis.
- How relevant, efficient and effective were the main contributions of UNDP to the immediate response?
- How relevant, efficient and effective were the main contributions of UNDP to the longer-term recovery?
- To what extent do you think the 21 November donor conference was effective? Why did you give it this rating?
- How effective do you think your deployment was? What was your most important achievement?
- What were the main enabling factors or constraints that determined the effectiveness of your deployment?
- Please explain in a few words if and how the disaster preparedness training at the July 2017 workshop helped you be more effective in this response
- What should have been added to that 2017 training, or done differently, in order for you to be more prepared?
- What is your overall assessment of UNDP's response to hurricanes Irma and Maria? Why did you give this rating?

2. UNDP Staff Self-Assessment Focus:

- UNDP's response
- Crisis Response mechanisms
- Operations
- Programmatic Response
- ER sector
- Partnerships
- Communications and Resource Mobilizations

Annex 5: Interview/survey/focus group results

Online survey narrative comments

How timely and efficient was UNDP's management and decision-making during the immediate response phase?

- There was an overall disconnect between RBLAC and CRU + BPPS in terms of vision/approach to the response and UNDP's positioning
- Strong RBLAC leadership and capacity to respond. CRU able to support RBLAC response
- Great RBLAC Director leadership, reliable CRU pro-activeness, BPPS seriously leaning into it, CO weak and hesitant, Regional hub on the ball
- The HQ and Panama Regional Hub support was immediate and very efficient, in terms of human resources deployment, procurement processes and decision making response. All the above mentioned support was provided under the leadership and with the support of Barbados CO, that was at times overwhelmed by the number of extensive hurricane related activities
- Top down with involvement of UNDP Regional Director
- Regional Director, RBLAC led from the front and invested the time, effort and energy. Additional resources were deployed
- Better information sharing amongst the deployed ERAs should have been facilitated to ensure the sharing of best practices and lessons learned. In addition, the release of allocated funding was very slow which would have enabled UNDP to deploy substantive experts much sooner
- The deployment of UNDP support staff from Barbados office made the operational/procurement process works very quick and efficient
- No time wasted on arguing eligibility/ineligibility. Focus was immediately on coming up with a good concept for effective intervention that offered both relief/recovery and longer-term capacity building
- Good decision making was supported by immediate involvement of the RBLAC Director which made all the difference, and the constant support of the Regional Bureau advisor which was quite exceptional (it can be explained by the level of political pressure, due to the China-Aid funding and corporate relationships with Beijing - reputational risk for UNDP Global was quite high). No decisions were delayed and strategic choices were made quite promptly. The engagement and leadership from the Barbados RC/RR was not as strong
- UNDP's knowledge of the key actors on the ground and the respect which they had gained from previous work undertaken at country level
- Good: Rapid deployment of UNDP staffers from NY. Weak: Distance to UNDP Offices in Barbados/Jamaica etc
- Strong leadership at the helm of the regional bureau. Very effective desk in the regional bureau. Very good coordination and team work between RBLAC and CRU, also with the rest of the house. Very good use of the crisis response mechanisms and structures
- Deployment of RTA from Panama in first 2 weeks after Irma & Maria, before SURGE ERA arrival was a key factor to success of UNDP's response. The excellent mission reporting and preliminary early recovery proposals provided a good launch-pad for finalizing the CERF & other regional funding proposals (TRAC3, etc)
- We had decision makers on the ground and very good support from home office
- A very experienced and talented team leader on the ground

- Good coordination mechanism put in place immediately. Direct support to Min Fin (Dominica) with dedicated human resources with direct line of communication with PS
- Led directly by NY; poor coordination and communication with all actors

How effective were UNDP's communications and resource mobilisation?

- UNDP did not mobilise a large amount of resources in the first 6/9 months after the hurricanes or later in the following year. For example, the resources from China and India were received as the donors approached us rather than as a proactive effort. However, not having had much contact with the COs or RBLAC on this, my impression might not be fully correct and be aware of all efforts made
- I was deployed after the initial emergency phase and my task was mainly to implement decisions
- Resource mobilisation was relatively good or effective but internal communication in my view needs a lot of work
- Very little attention to communication, no SURGE reinforcements, no celebration of early success, no pictures, weak outreach to the Banks, tentative relationship with Banks, no coordination on RM front: no strategy, no plan, no conviction
- Hustled for resources, but comms weaker
- Quick funding support made the works effective
- A lot of people came to the NY fund-raising conference and announced oodles of cash. It is unclear to me at this stage how much actually materialized, was new/additional -- and came through UNDP! Nothing of that, to my knowledge, reached XXX, certainly through UNDP
- The recruitment of a communications expert took much longer than expected therefore despite the support from HQ, the comms were weak at the beginning. Resource mobilization was handled directly by HQ
- Good given limited funds
- XXX is a British Territory. Even though I linked up effectively to British Red Cross, I could not get the opportunity to meet the British Consul. The British army chaired the NDC but I found it a bit difficult to engage effectively with the British emergency & early recovery personnel who were there. Sometimes I felt they didn't want to know UNDP ERA was around. These relations would be best agreed at top organizational level in order that communication channels are open when ERAs are deployed
- In my view, the resource mobilisation was successful but we could have done better in communications
- Rapid response to Host Country requests and daily presence in Officials office
- Corporately UNDP should invest more to partner with donors on post disaster recovery
- There was a concentrated effort to raise funds locally and internationally
- Poor communication by NY on how and what resources were being mobilized; poor documentation and/or sharing of results of donor conference

To what extent were Gender Equality and the Empowerment of Women and Girls included in your planning, advocacy or programming work?

- More so evident in the emergency employment programmes
- I have reviewed some project concept notes prepared for XXX and I did not see such a strong gender element. I was not involved in the design of the housing programme so I cannot tell for these programmes in Dominica and Barbuda

- The PAHO team was a good mix of male and female officers
- Took deliberate steps to design gender-sensitive projects and to compose gender-sensitive teams
- Ensure greater participation of women in the CERF-funded emergency livelihoods - debris management programme; reflect gender aspects in the Housing Recovery Policy and Programme
- Assistance in local information gathering, supply of much needed essentials like food, water, gas, directions etc
- A UNDP partnership with UN Women on the islands was among the options but no one responded to the idea
- All proposals had clear mentions of ensuring that vulnerable groups should be prioritised and women were always mentioned in this context
- Women participation was very high
- Both rapid responder/SURGE Adviser were women, and both made explicit, repeated references to gender as a major consideration. As a result, project data confirms that women benefited slightly more proportionately.
- Even though we planned the CfW initiative in close consultation with UNWOMEN, it was not implemented during the immediate response. The lack of available data also made it challenging
- The other area of work was the reroofing project and the Building damage assessment data allowed to collect data on gender and female headed-households however several challenges occurred, thus preventing UNDP to adopt an approach targeting key vulnerable groups that would have included women and girls
- Worked closely with UN Women to ensure inclusion of their findings
- Our team was mixed
- Advocacy for women in debris clearance / cfw
- Our focus is always on the most vulnerable male or female
- Cash-for-Work was open equally to men & women
- Ensuring agencies with relevant programmes are included in coordination and appeals
- We paid attention to engage women in the temporary employment programme and training on housing repairs and building code
- Employment of woman local employment to management positions, support for government employment program with high woman's participating
- Promote the inclusion of women in EEP and BDA teams
- PDNA social impact assessment focuses on gender and other human issues

Assess the effectiveness of these UNDP crisis response tools in this crisis:

- In terms of the SURGE deployments consideration should be given to extended deployments to COs to assist with proposal writing, procurement and general operation matters. Some SURGE support was provided in the first 2 to 4 months after hazard impact but nothing since then
- On some of the Crisis Response Packages, I have no opinion as I was not involved on the programming on the ground on issues related to debris/emergency employment. However, as for the one on recovery, the package was not really proposed as such to the COs. My overall impression is that there's be no sharing of the packages as such but rather an ad hoc approach on each of the elements of each package that had to be dealt with. My judgement on the Business Case vs Surge plan is really to this specific case where the business case seemed to be taken into account by the regional bureau much more than the surge plan. Possibly the two should be merged into a single process

- Systematization of the tools, especially Building damage assessment. And making the partnership with EWB a corporate arrangement
- Simplify
- I suggest the creation of an operational SOP for operations in the field
- Share with countries early on what support could be provided; Establish relationship with highest level decision makers through UNDP mission
- Get more assistance from Caribbean Engineering Professionals. Make it easier for our participation
- UNDP needs to do SURGE planning first, develop recovery frameworks later. In this response we lost a lot of time and opportunity because of that. For 3 months UNDP was "advising governments" without even starting to pursue a UNDP business case for recovery. Once there was a UNDP business case it took 6 or 7 months to deploy key people like P5 programme manager and P3 operations manager; that is intolerable
- Good to grab CERF resources for debris mgmt, but then follow through was poor except for Dominica
- They work well. UNDP should return to having a Bureau for Crisis Prevention, Recovery and Resilience
- The Donor Conference was good to highlight the issues at the political level but from a resource mobilisation perspective, it did not add much as most countries reiterated pledges that were mostly promised and earmarked to specific islands. I can of course only speak from my time (2 months) on XXX
- On debris management, emergency employment and recovery planning and coordination, I have no direct knowledge of the extent to which the tool was used, though I assume it was since we had UNDP staff on the ground from Irma +1 through to end November
- The tools are all excellent. What is needed is a customized policy support to the staffs being SURG-ed in order for them to make the right choices and make use of their time efficiently. i.e. how much time should I have spent trying to set-up a CfW initiative worth 27,000 USD vs. spending time on developing a longer-term livelihoods programme?
- Also, on deployments and procurement sometimes it would be more important to spend a bit more time recruiting the right consultant than having a consultant very quickly (because in my case we had to send the consultant back)
- I deployed in the first weeks for UNDAC/OCHA. I did not see any field presence/coordination by UNDP. Particularly in the area of debris/waste management, environmental management, advisory to Governments and CDEMA I would have expected more pro-activeness
- Happy with debris management
- Do no harm to the impacted state economy, buy locally, empower local first
- The articulation between immediate crisis response and longer term recovery requires greater attention
- For the Caribbean region I think it's vital to have a clear understanding on ECLAC's role re. PDNA viz arrangements with WB, etc., on PDNA
- Better communications between HQ and field office on SURGE deployments and plan
- More flexibility

How relevant, efficient and effective were the main contributions of UNDP to the immediate response?

- I am not sure about what we are looking at with immediate response. If debris cleaning etc. - it seems that we have provided good support on this. If we are also looking at advisory services to governments on recovery, this is an area where UNDP has done well - also considering the political difficulties in some islands/sensitivities

- Mostly China. China was the only donor that came through immediately. The EU and WB PDNA partnership was also effective and immediate. The partnership with CARICOM was crucial
- UNDP's involvement was in early recovery and recovery planning. The CERF-Funded debris management programme provided emergency livelihoods to the affected persons after the hurricanes
- UNDP personnel seem to be looking at their computers and looking as if they are busy and doing something while the affected persons are not receiving the required help. It's all about themselves
- The immediate response may have been good for the beneficiary islands that received advisory services (I cannot judge). The immediate response did not (do) much good for UNDP and its ability to start meaning more for those islands and become a cornerstone and a go-to agency for the medium to long term
- UNDP showed how important it was to deploy first class people asap
- The quicker funding support for the programme would make more significant impact
- In the end, my feeling is that, in the immediate aftermath of the hurricane, the Government of TCI made no use of the on-the-spot, available UNDP/UNDAC expertise
- Our direct contribution to the immediate response was mostly the coordination of all the partners, as requested by the Government and along the lines of the coordination mechanism set up by UNDP the first week of the SURGE deployment. The mechanism was seen quite positively by all partners and the GoAB
- The rest of our contribution relied on a complex procurement process and the Government did not understand why the project took so long to kick-off
- The Building Damage Assessment was a good intermediary result which allowed to build the trust with the Government and demonstrated UNDP's ability to systematize the response
- Establish a liaison with affected governments and CDEMA
- UNDP's contribution is not understood
- There were some tensions between the emphasis on immediate response pushed by the leadership of RBLAC and a broader perspective (longer term recovery and climate resilience) advocated by the disaster/climate team in BPPS. This should not be mutually exclusive and UNDP should work on both in a complementary manner - but given UNDP's limited resources it led to some tensions
- Get there earlier if possible
- During immediate response phase, participate more in humanitarian coordination and planning
- To show UNDP on the ground to bilateral donors, to forge partnerships for future disasters response

How relevant, efficient and effective were the main contributions of UNDP to the longer-term recovery?

- More support to CO in facilitating the longer term recovery especially for COs covering more than one impacted state
- It is difficult to judge this as the recovery process is still ongoing. Also, having limited contact with the ground, it is difficult to know if/what the COs are actually implementing
- Mainly the EU and the World Bank. The PDNA partnership was also very effective
- UNDP should have been more proactive to situate some ground presence in disaster prone countries ahead of the actual occurrence of a disaster
- Tried to develop more political buy in and understanding of UNDP's role and expertise in recovery planning and coordination, and various tools such as PDNA and development of recovery framework
- Get on the ground and guide/work...not the offices and keep secretive

- UNDP lost precious time first by not having a plan and second by very slowly implementing the plan. We should have started implementing recovery from day 1 (including roofs but much much more than that), we should have communicated this work strongly from day 2 and then we should have positioned UNDP as the go-to Agency for governments and banks. The evidence I have (which is limited) is that we did not do that. Anyway nobody I worked with in the short period of time except XXX ever believed we had any chance on bank loan funding to be implemented through UNDP. If we don't believe it ourselves, how can we ever convince others???
- UNDP faced the same mix of logistical/human resource/govt decision-making constraints that others faced
- I am not aware of what was done and decided on that front. I did put forward longer term proposals but this has probably been addressed by the successor
- Again, despite everyone's best efforts, and certainly a constant concern about speed of reaction, our interventions took, in my view, too long to contribute to 'recovery' per se, though we can claim to have contributed, in a very small way, to the longer-term development of the country
- We should have been much better positioned on our ability to advise the Government on building regulations in the region, i.e. should have engaged from the beginning with OECS and CDEMA at the regional level in order to better understand what the needs were in terms of capacity building in all the affected islands. That could only be done with the support of an engineer and it took almost 2 months to get the engineer on the ground. I think UNDP should not waste their time with short-term initiative with visibility potential such as CfW, when it is not really our added value...we should have assessed right away what longer-term recovery would mean and focused on that
- I am not aware of any long term contributions made by UNDP
- It is a bit early to say but there has been a number of positive moves and developments, such as the advisory support provided to Governments (e.g. joint team in Dominica; support to BVI); the secondment of a senior advisor to CARICOM; leadership on the PDNA; etc. The two issues I would flag are (i) the need for better linkages between immediate response and longer term recovery in UNDP - and the need to invest catalytic funding into recovery, primarily on advisory services; and (ii) the need for sustained engagement beyond the initial phase
- I think we did very well considering its a British Territory & high income classification
- Resource mobilization at corporate level

To what extent do you think the 21 November donor conference was effective? Why did you give it this rating?

- Based on initial reports and discussions with partners
- The conference created a momentum and indeed a lot was pledged
- As for UNDP, I think the conference was good to raise our credibility vis-a-vis regional institutions and affected governments. As for the larger international community and donors, I am not so sure as the conference was yet branded UN and CARICOM while in actual fact it was only UNDP to support its organisation
- The conference was mostly important to mobilize attention to the Caribbean. So its importance was mostly political
- In the long term it was also important to mobilize funds to the Region. But it was not immediate
- The commitments made at the donor conference were largely reiteration of what was already committed by different donors. It didn't seem to generate any new commitments. Also there was very little allocation for OCT
- What I saw is that they are all self-serving and in it for the money

- RBLAC was successful to have a maximum exposure of the region to donor support, this was a dramatic credibility gain for UNDP
- The Chinese, Indian and EU funding were already in the pipeline and basically confirmed when I was in Barbados (Nov 2017). The success of RM is to be measured by the amounts that were mobilized later. I heard of some bank funding for BVI and also of Netherlands funding, but as far as I can see, this is very limited if measured against the RM ambition and the rationale for the corporate investment into the business case
- Holding the meeting forced some donors to speed up decision-making, and showed UNDP as a real partner to CARICOM and the affected countries
- UNDP was seen as a trust partner and CARICOM asked UNDP for its support and not any other partner. UNDP's Senior Advisor was embedded in the Office of the Secretary General which positioned very well. The donors saw UNDP differently in the region. UNDP was also able to use this partnership to speak to the need for a Regional Resilience Programme. As a consequence of UNDP's support to the Donor Conference, UNDP is now currently providing technical and policy support to advance a Regional Resilience Programme. It has a position of unique trust and the Donors are looking to UNDP with more frequency and higher regard
- Somewhat for the region although, as mentioned previously none of the funding was "new". All islands received funding from government with whom they had a current or former historical affiliation. Most cases related to EU countries who were expected to "take care" of the reconstruction efforts
- Irrespective of the reality of the large pledges, our ability to organize such a large, high-level conference was impressive, particularly given that it took place in collaboration with CARICOM
- It was a good conference in terms of visibility for UNDP, not sure how much the donors honored their promises
- I have heard expressions of positive feedback regarding UNDP's involvement
- From my limited perspective from debris, it engaged and demonstrated to the govt that UNDP were valuable
- UNDP did well in supporting the organization of the conference, giving it content etc. This is something we do for the countries themselves, and not for our own sake. But indirectly it gives us a lot of credibility
- I had to leave after 6 weeks and no news on outcome of conference & no sense of UNDP's credibility at the end of it all
- Because of the amount of the pledge made
- The individual people involved were among the best I have experienced, Bravo
- The conference managed to put the affected countries at the core of the international agenda, however resource mobilization could have been more significant for UNDP
- Since the information on the donor conference results/pledges was not widely shared/not transparent, it is really hard to say

How effective do you think your deployment was? What was your most important achievement?

- Getting most of the children back to school by the end of the 2017, in a safe environment and with the basic services such as waters and sanitation
- Creating an inventory of donated portable generators, identifying the need for creating a cadre of electricians in the island that could install, maintain and repair them; proposing a workshop for electricians and maintenance personnel across all sectors (education, community housing, health, foreign affairs); coopting all aid agencies in participating; identifying participants and trainers; planning logistics of training event; promoting cooperation of all stakeholders

- Creation of the UNDP Office in Dominica, and negotiating with the local authorities tax exemptions for storage containers without costs
- Support to the government in drafting the Recovery Plan, Concept note on the Recovery Agency, Housing Recovery Policy and Plan
- Sourcing essential parts for the Blackstart generator and getting Power back on the Island of Tortola. Same with RO Plant and getting Water back on the island
- Completion of DRR sector analysis for the PDNA, supported the 1st mission of the Chinese delegation in Dominica
- Co-drafting the Hurricane Recovery Programme for Dominica, A&B, BVI and Sint Martin
- I served as the Lead Advisor and Conference Coordinator for the CARICOM-UN High Level Pledging Conference that yielded \$1.6 billion in grant pledges for the affected countries and territories
- The main achievement was in making the Dutch Ministry of Interior understand the value added of the UN system and UNDP in supporting immediate and longer term recovery from the hurricane. This materialised in an allocation of almost EU2M to immediate recovery projects proposals that I developed
- 1) kick off the roofing repair initiative supported by China (despite all the logistical constraints. 2) Establishment of UNDP presence in Antigua and Barbuda
- Completing the Post Disaster Needs Assessment in a timely manner with the lead of the host country
- Conduct an initial rapid assessment on the situation in Barbuda during the evacuation of the island; Help establish the 3W for Anguilla; Establish initial contact lists for responders in Antigua
- Continued support to HC and CDEMA and having staff and capacity on the ground when Maria hit Dominica
- Deployed for 4 SIDS, but visited A&B & BVI - twice each over 1 month. Strategic advice to Govts & Allocation of BVI Surge Funding for Debris Management
- A One UN document for the recovery of Sint Maarten to submit to GoNL and GoSM
- Linked UNRC to TCI Govt again after long absence. NDMO referred to UNRC as the absentee father who everyone had lost touch with. By the time I left the reconnection was on the way to achieving solid results in terms of early recovery & longer term engagement of UNRC/ UNDP RR with TCI govt & stakeholders
- Damage assessment and roof replacement program
- Management of the comprehensive BDA of about 30k buildings with over 140 staff involved. Technical advice on resources mobilization and the implementation of the Emergency Employment Programme through the NEP

What were the main enabling factors or constraints that determined the effectiveness of your deployment?

- Knowledge of host countries health system and personnel + knowledge of how the international agencies work in emergencies; strong support from PAHO emergency unit in Barbados; good PAHO team at all levels
- Existing relationship between the RC and Government rep overseeing Recovery efforts helped; there was lack of understanding on UNDP's part on the exact needs and where the country was in its path to recovery. I was introduced via email to the Government counterpart; a senior UNDP official's visit to do the introductions to relevant government officials would have helped to save time taken to build these relationships from scratch; Being the only person deployed to the country with no UNDP presence or program, many stakeholders were not aware of UNDP and the nature and scope of our work or support it could provide in early recovery. Absence of UN/UNDP mission from the RC or other senior officials

during the duration of the deployment, also contributed to this. Some of the Departments therefore saw UN/UNDP as an outside agency, parachuting in, to tell them what to do. Some of the opportunities to effectively guide recovery (through a coordination mechanism, PDNA, etc.) were lost as these were not offered early on in the process of recovery

- Enabling Factors: Assistance with STRE and Commandos. Constraints: None...just have to be prepared to work in any situation
- Familiarity with the region and the national counterparts
- The HRP report was very well received by the Crisis Board, however the implementation of the programme suffered delays compared to the proposed timeline. During my deployment in the Barbados CO, there were several times when priorities were not clearly established and also efforts were duplicated between the CO and the teams on the ground in the affected countries
- Clear need for policy and technical support. Access to the highest levels in the region both at the national and regional levels. Embedded in CARICOM with UNDP being recognised for its contribution in key fora by leadership of CARICOM including in writing
- The challenge for UNDP was to find someone that spoke Dutch. Although not a requirement to engage with the Host Government or the local population, this was an important aspect of engaging with the major and only donor, the Dutch Ministry of Interior
- Enabling factors: 1) Strong leadership and direct engagement from Regional Bureau at highest levels; 2) Agreement by Regional Bureau to fast track operations (especially procurement) ; 3) Targeted support from CRU on early recovery coordination; 4) Having one focal point in RBLAC/HQ clearly made a difference;
5) RBLAC liaison with Permanent Mission in NY, which trickled down well at country level and positively impacted relationship with the GoAB
- Constraints: 1) Capacities and quality of the support from the Panama Hub - big mistakes made on procurement and recruitment; 2) UNDP's risk aversion when it comes to fast-tracking procurement and logistics; 3) Multi-Country Office set-up and working with remote support from Barbados was clearly an issue - finance and procurement; 4) Partnership with UNVs in MIC environments to be discussed (inadequacy of stipend); 5) Lack of clarity as to whom to get policy support from, in HQ (especially BPPS) / benefiting from lessons learned from other countries; 6) Operating in an environment with no previous UNDP presence. Big opportunities missed in terms of cost-efficiency for UN System
- Knowledgeable team members and ability to work well with counterparts
- Most enabling was the support of the RC in Barbados and the resources we were giving to travel within the region. The biggest constraints came from CDEMA. The working relationship with CDEMA was very difficult Enabling: Receptive civil service & presence of 1 other UNDP staff. Constraints: Lack of UNDP office in country and ministerial politics (favoured contractors)
- Enablers: direct entry GoSM and GoNL highest levels; excellent relations UN agencies; Constraints: limited access to resources (technical & financial)
- UNDP deployed a senior programme manager with me at start & end of assignment. The start was effective for my immediate orientation to country & for his learning about CRU & SURGE. At the end it was good for him to come back for a smooth hand over and especially as UNRC & UNDP DRR were visiting for the first time the same week I left. There were some launches for UNRC to officiate at plus continue high level talks with Govt on outcome of DALA / PDNA carried out by ECLAC the week I left
- Rapid deployment and response to Host Country
- Human group deployed was the most enabling factor: high capacity and great attitudes. An amazing human capital deployed to Dominica; Constraints: disbursement of DSA

Please explain in a few words if and how the disaster preparedness training at the July 2017 workshop helped you be more effective in this response

- Training was good but was a lot to take in. It however assisted in allowing for a fuller appreciation of what UNDP tools exist
- At minimum it raised awareness on the support to be received by the country office in crisis situations and allowed national staff to be confident in accepting Surge support to respond to crises
- Knowledge of UNDP SOPs for disaster response but especially establishing relationships with colleagues that were deployed in Dominica
- For the amount these workshops cost, it would be much more effective to do direct mentorship with COs. It is not realistic to expect COs to be prepared after a 4 day workshop which covers an enormous amount of material, and then send these 2 individuals back to the CO and their daily work, and have them implement this. It gives the COs an overview of the materials/tools, but it is a superficial version of "preparedness"

What should have been added to that 2017 training, or done differently, in order for you to be more prepared?

- Longer discussions on the tools and more country offices previous experiences in terms of what worked well and didn't go so well
- Risk specific (hurricane) preparedness planning with concrete measures to be taken by the country office.
- It was a very good workshop. A recommendation is to have surge advisors taking the UNDAC training as well
- Focus on and provide direct mentorship with COs who have repetitive disasters: Barbados, Cuba, Haiti, DR, Guatemala, Honduras, Chile, Peru, Bolivia. I would recommend one overview workshop every 4 years for all COs in the region, and then targeted capacity building with the COs who deserve and need more attention

What is your overall assessment of UNDP's response to hurricanes Irma and Maria? Why did you give this rating?

- I would give this rating in view of the overall efforts that UNDP did - there was a commitment to do well and it translated into concrete actions. However, some flaws or lack of results are due to internal UNDP issues between the various bureaux involved in response and the different engagement/vision of UNDP's role in recovery. Certainly, the peculiarity of the region with challenges posed also by the limited presence of UNDP, limited the scope and effectiveness of the response
- The response was very uneven across different countries. There should be better mechanisms for communication and information sharing between the teams in the affected countries
- The lack of vision, ambition and self-confidence of UNDP that clearly showed from most colleagues who were playing a role in this response, leads to half-hearted implementation of any of its plans: no poise, no speed, dominance of small personal motives (who is taking what job). An organization that does not really and wholeheartedly believe in itself cannot expect support from its stakeholders, be it donors or governments
- Very effective in spite of logistical/procurement problems on the China project

- If the deployment was done earlier, the impact of UNDP support should have been more effective
- Effectiveness in a crisis builds on familiarity before the crisis. This requires continuing, long-term investment to maintain the relationship, which is difficult to do in the absence of a physical presence in country and/or an operational portfolio of projects. You can only live so long on your reputation
- Many lessons to learn. We have good tools and policy content. We have a lot of experience in many countries. However we tend to want to do too much and our procedures in crisis-response are just killing us.
- UNDP Barbados staff that we work with and know are very absent may be we need to build their capacity
- It would be beneficial to train as surge and/or first responders and/or UNDAC the UNDP human capital that participated in this response
- Has a cost-benefit analysis of UNDP's "investment" been done? Enormous resources were expended on the response and recovery for high-income and overseas territory countries (of England and the Netherlands). While this was responsive and perhaps politically astute, it also raises questions about UNDP priorities and allocation of resources. Will this pay off in terms of positioning? (was that the goal?)

UNDP staff self-assessment

	1 = Not at all up to 6 = Completely	1	2	3	4	5	6		
DELIVERY	1. UNDP's response was adequate in terms of:								
	a) Speed				X				
	b) Scale				X				
	c) Quality					X			
	d) Field presence to respond effectively to needs					X			
	e) Addressing the specific needs and vulnerabilities of women, men, girls, boys, elderly, disabled, and other vulnerable people.				X				
	f) Ensuring a gender approach				X				
Mechanisms	2. UNDP's Crisis Response Mechanisms were adequate in terms of:								
	a) Management and decision-making during the immediate response					X			
	b) First Responders deployments					X			
	c) Surge deployments					X			
Operations	3. UNDP's Operations were adequate in terms of:								
	a) Fast Track measures				X				
	b) Procurement			X					
	c) Other Operations (HR, sub-offices,)				X				
Programmatic response: 4. UNDP's programmatic response was adequate in terms of:									
	a) immediate response				X				
	b) Longer Term actions				X				

	1 = Not at all up to 6 = Completely	1	2	3	4	5	6		
	c) Use of Crisis Response Packages				X				
	d) Nexus: Linking short term to long terms actions				X				
ER sector	5. UNDP's ER work was adequate in terms of:								
	a) Responding to the sector needs effectively				X				
	b) Participating in joint assessments (PDNA, MIRA, etc)				X				
Partners hips	6. UNDP's established effective partnerships with:								
	a) Government					X			
	b) UN Agencies				X				
	c) NGOs				X				
	d) Donors				X				
Communications and Resource mobilization: 7. UNDP's work was adequate in terms of:									
	e) Timely internal communication				X				
	f) Effective external communication				X				
	g) Effective resource mobilization				X				
	h)								

